

# *HANDBOOK FOR POSTGRADUATE RESEARCH STUDENTS AND SUPERVISORS*

[www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool/](http://www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool/)

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Introduction to the University of Liverpool Graduate School - <http://www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool/>

The aim of this handbook is to give guidance for both students and staff on the management of postgraduate research in the University. It includes the University's various Codes of Practice which apply to postgraduate research and should be read in conjunction with the Ordinances and Regulations for the relevant degrees.

This version of the handbook is effective from the 2007/08 session and supersedes any previous versions. However, postgraduate students registered before the start of the 2007/08 session should be aware that they will be subject to earlier versions of the various Ordinances and Regulations, which may be found in the University Calendar for the year of their first registration.

All postgraduate research students and their supervisors are members of the Graduate School which aims to give all postgraduate research students every assistance in achieving the goal of the award of a higher degree. It is also concerned with both the academic and personal skills aspects of a student's life and aims to foster a stimulating research environment. It achieves this by a well defined hierarchy of Departmental and Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research led by The University Director of Postgraduate Research who is Professor Clive Edwards. The Graduate School is also supported by a dedicated team of administrative and clerical staff based in the Foundation Building ([gsoffice@liv.ac.uk](mailto:gsoffice@liv.ac.uk)) who oversee all spheres of activity from admissions to final submission of a thesis and the subsequent examination.

In addition, the Graduate School is responsible for ensuring that all academic staff who supervise research students are properly prepared to do so and that they discharge their responsibilities in accordance with the University's agreed standards. The members of staff in the Graduate School are shown on p3. Students therefore have identifiable means of access to different sectors of the university administration.

## STAFF OF THE GRADUATE SCHOOL

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## Higher Degrees by Research

The following higher degrees by research are awarded by this University:

|                     |                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| All Faculties       | Doctor in Philosophy (PhD)<br>Master of Philosophy (MPhil)<br>Master of Research (MRes)<br>Professional Doctorates (e.g. DClinPsychol) |
| Faculty of Medicine | Doctor of Medicine (MD)<br>Master of Dental Surgery (MDS)                                                                              |
| School of Law       | Master of Laws (LLM)                                                                                                                   |

*This handbook is aimed principally at those students on the generic research degrees (MPhil and PhD) and those taking the MD in the Faculty of Medicine, and the staff who supervise and manage them. (Note that where different procedures apply to the MD, these are identified in the text.)*

*At the time of going to press, procedures for the registration and administration of postgraduate research students on Research Master's and Professional Doctorate programme are being developed. This handbook will be updated to include this information once the procedures have been agreed. In the meantime, the approved frameworks for both sets of students are included in section 3.*

*In the following text, the word 'department' stands for any academic Department or School within which students and staff are based.*

## SECTION I: Information for Postgraduate Research Students

### Introduction

This section of the Postgraduate Handbook is intended to provide information for prospective and current University of Liverpool postgraduate researchers. It covers all formal stages from admission through to graduation.

#### 1. Applying for Admission

- 1.1 Applications for admission can now be made online. The form and notes for guidance can be found at [http://www.liv.ac.uk/study/postgraduate/how\\_to\\_apply.htm](http://www.liv.ac.uk/study/postgraduate/how_to_apply.htm). The final decision for acceptance of an applicant for a postgraduate research degree rests with the academic department in which the student intends to pursue the research.
- 1.2 Once the department has considered your application, you will either receive a formal offer letter from UKSRO or from the relevant clinical faculty office, which will detail the terms of registration, your supervisors, the fees for the first year of study and any sponsorship of which the University is aware, or you will receive a formal rejection letter.
- 1.3 As part of the admissions process, it is necessary for the University to determine the fee status of all applications. In order for the University to do this, any applicant who shows a connection with a country other than the UK on the application form will be sent a Fee Status Questionnaire to complete and return. The Questionnaire includes Notes for Guidance, which briefly explains the Regulations governing fee status. Further information on fee classification can be obtained from Student Administration and Support, the Foundation Building. You should be aware that if you are sent a Fee Status Questionnaire and do not complete and return it, the University will assume that your status is 'Overseas' and charge the higher fee.
- 1.4 The normal expectation is that research students register for the degree of MPhil in the first instance, which can be upgraded to PhD after satisfactory progress has been made and a minimum period of time completed. If your progress is deemed to be insufficient for a recommendation to change your registration from MPhil to PhD to be made after two years you will only be eligible to submit work for the degree of MPhil or in extreme cases your registration may be terminated. Occasionally, students are offered registration direct for PhD, normally when they already possess an MPhil or Masters degree by research. (This does not apply to registration for the degree of MD, which has separate prerequisites.)

#### 2. Registration

- 2.1 You are required to register at the start of your first year of study, before you begin research for the degree, and at the start of each academic session thereafter until your thesis has been submitted. On the first occasion, you will register in your department (the department will send you details) but re-registration will be dependent on satisfactory annual reviews of progress in your department which are used by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research to make a recommendation by way of the Annual Progress Report (See below).
- 2.2 Once you have registered, the University will issue you with a Student ID card, which is also your library card. If this card is lost or stolen, you will need to contact the Enquiries desk in Facilities Management (Oxford Street) to request a replacement card. Please note that a small charge is levied for a replacement card unless your card has been stolen and you can produce a copy of the police crime report.

#### 3. Tuition Fees

- 3.1 Tuition Fees are payable for the duration of your research degree and are normally charged on an annual basis. Fees must be paid at the Tuition Fees Office, Ground Floor, Foundation Building. Some information about arrangements for paying fees are given below. More detailed information is available in the official Fee Payment Guide, which can be collected from the Tuition Fees Office or found online at: <http://www.liv.ac.uk/sas/administration/feepayment.pdf>

### 3.2 Self funded students

If you are a self-funded student you can pay for your first year (or part of the year if you start in the middle of the academic session) in full, and then pay for each subsequent year of study in full at the beginning of the academic year.

Alternatively, self-sponsored students may pay their fees each year in instalments. Details of these arrangements are given in the Fee Payment leaflet. Please note that if you fail to pay fees at the required times, the University reserves the right to withdraw facilities from you until any debts are cleared. Therefore, if you find that you are having difficulties in paying your fees when they are due, you must contact the Tuition Fees Office or the Accounts Receivable Office immediately.

Please note that further sanctions may apply if debts remain unpaid. This will lead to the removal of access to University facilities, including Library and Computing Services access (although you will be keep access to your University email account to enable the University to maintain contact with you), until the debt is cleared. Please also be aware that where a financial suspension is imposed by the University rather than granted (see Section 16 below), your registration timescale will continue and any time lost during an imposed suspension will not be returned to you. If you are still financially suspended after six months your studies will be terminated.

Ultimately, no student with an outstanding debt to the University is permitted to graduate.

### 3.3 Sponsored students

If you are being sponsored for your studies, for example by a Government body, a Research Council or a private company, you must provide the Graduate School and the Tuition Fees Office with a letter from your sponsor confirming the terms of your sponsorship.

Please note that if the letter from your sponsor states that your sponsorship is only for a limited period of time and does not cover your full period of registration, you will either need to provide evidence of continued sponsorship or you will be treated as a self-funded student and become liable for payment of your own fees.

Postgraduate studentships arranged by the University but funded by external sources are offered strictly on the understanding that the University cannot guarantee to continue to fund the studentship in the event that the external sponsor withdraws support.

Please note that sanctions may apply if sponsorship or studentship letters or payments are not provided to the University. This will lead to the removal of access to University facilities, including Library and Computing Services access (although you will be keep access to your University email account to enable the University to maintain contact with you), until the debt is cleared. Please also be aware that where a financial suspension is imposed by the University rather than granted (see Section 16 below), your registration timescale will continue and any time lost during an imposed suspension will not be returned to you. If you are still financially suspended after six months your studies will be terminated.

### 3.4 Fee Status

Your fee status should have been determined as part of the admission process and your fee classification code will appear on your registration form. There are various levels of fees: UK students who meet the criteria to be classified as 'home' will incur the 'home' rate fee, as will students classified as 'EU'. Any student classified as 'Overseas' will be charged the higher, overseas fee. There are separate fees charged to any students from the Channel Islands and Isle of Man. Any queries about your fee status must be raised with Student Administration and Support, the Foundation Building.



### 3.5 Fee Levels

For postgraduate research students, there are varying fee levels, as follows:

- Full-time – the normal fee charged to full-time students on the main campus
- Part-time – a reduced fee charged to part-time students
- Full-time (off-site) – a special fee charged to full-time students who have been given specific approval to conduct the majority of their research degree away from the University of Liverpool campus (often in an overseas institution).
- Submission Pending fee – a continuation fee charged to students who have completed their primary research (for at least the minimum required registration period) and are solely engaged in writing up their thesis for submission. (NB: the change to ‘Submission Pending’ status is NOT automatic at the end of three years full time. It must be recommended by one of your supervisors in reply to an email sent out by the Graduate School approximately 3 months before your finishing date.

Current fee levels can be found at <http://www.liv.ac.uk/sas/administration/coursefees.htm>.

Alternatively, you can email [feesenq@liv.ac.uk](mailto:feesenq@liv.ac.uk) to ascertain current fees.

Please note that additional fees (bench fees or research support costs) may be payable to cover some costs of your research. Where this is the case, your formal offer letter will give details. Current banding levels for bench fees or research support costs are as follows:

|          |   |        |
|----------|---|--------|
| • Band 1 | = | £0     |
| • Band 2 | = | £1,250 |
| • Band 3 | = | £3,000 |
| • Band 4 | = | £5,000 |

Certain subjects may charge higher fees and the reasons for these higher costs will be fully explained in your formal offer letter.

If a student, following examination of their thesis, is required to make a subsequent application for the degree (resubmission), a ‘resubmission pending’ fee and a re-examination fee will be charged.

### 3.6 Queries

All fees are reviewed annually and are usually raised. Queries regarding tuition fees should be directed to the Tuition Fees Office in the Foundation Building or email [feesenq@liv.ac.uk](mailto:feesenq@liv.ac.uk).

## 4. The Graduate School Skills Programme

- 4.1 A research degree from the University of Liverpool includes attendance and completion of the Graduate School Skills Programme. It is compulsory for all research students. If you can supply evidence that you have already completed a similar programme elsewhere e.g. in a Masters programme, you may be eligible for exemption from some of the Skills Programme’s constituent parts. You can apply for exemption using a form available from the Graduate School website which has to be signed by your primary supervisor and Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research and sent to your Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research. You can apply for exemption from subject specific training delivered by your department by applying to your Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. Exemption from the Personal Development Record and University Poster Day is not permitted. Over the course of your studies you must amass at least 180 credits of training.

- 4.2 Successful completion of the programme will consist of credit or exempted\* credit for the following sections:
- First Year Skills Workshop = 30 training credits
  - Subject specific Training = at least 30 training credits
  - Personal Development Record = 30 training credits annually\*
  - University Poster Day = 10 credits\*
  - Career Skills = 30 training credits
- (\*Exemption not permitted)

Each credit represents approximately one hour of attendance or other activity. Without evidence of these being achieved (either through training or evidence of prior attainment of the skills via the exemption process), you will not be permitted to submit your thesis for examination. It is the research student's responsibility to ensure they complete the Skills Programme before the thesis is submitted.

- 4.3 The Skills Programme meets the recommendations of the Roberts Report (*SET for Success*) and those laid down by all Research Councils and the AHRC by requiring all new research students to complete developmental activities that add up to at least six weeks of training over a three-year period.
- 4.4 Each year, you must complete a skills audit with your supervisor, and plan your Skills Training using the online Personal Development Record (PDR), which has been designed to enable students to reflect on their activities, experiences and skills.
- 4.5 The Personal Development Record itself forms the equivalent of three weeks of developmental activity over three years. It does this through the recording of the developmental experiences that you will normally engage with during your studies both inside and outside of the University. In addition to the Personal Development Record, the core of the Skills Programme comprises two intensive three-day workshops, run by the Graduate School Skills Team, and at least a week's worth of subject-specific training which will be offered in your department or faculty.
- 4.6 The intensive workshops offered by the Graduate School Skills Team are as follows: a First Year Skills Workshop generally taken in the first year and a Career Skills Workshop, usually for either second or third years. Both workshops are based on experiential learning and map their learning outcomes against the Joint Skills Statement. The First Year Skills Workshop aims to promote teamwork and interdisciplinary activity. It also provides important networking opportunities for postgraduates, encouraging further developmental activities. There is a choice of themes for this workshop and research students are advised to sign up for the workshop of their choice as soon after registration as possible. Part-time students and those based off-site from the University campus may take an online alternative to the First Year Skills Workshop.
- 4.7 The Career Skills Workshops, which have been granted UKGRAD equivalency, will be based on the successful formula currently being delivered by UKGRAD and will be open to some research council funded students from other universities as well as University of Liverpool research students. If you are funded by a research council (AHRC, BBSRC, ESRC, EPSRC, STFC and Wellcome Trust) then you are also free and eligible to attend a UK Grad School at another institution in order to comply with your training requirements. Other alternatives to this training are currently being developed and include entry into Research Council approved entrepreneurship competitions and other similar activities.
- 4.8 MD students should consult their School's training policy in relation to the Skills Programme as some activities, such as completion of the Personal Development Record, are compulsory in some Schools.
- 4.9 The Graduate School website contains detailed information about the Skills Programme, including links to the Research Training Manual (online catalogue of available Skills Training) [http://dbweb.liv.ac.uk/cll/pg\\_training/rtrm/create\\_programme.asp](http://dbweb.liv.ac.uk/cll/pg_training/rtrm/create_programme.asp) and the Personal Development Record software. [www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool](http://www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool)
- 4.10 Queries about the University's Graduate School Skills Programme should be directed to the Graduate School Skills Team (GSSP@liv.ac.uk).

## 5. Annual Progress Monitoring

- 5.1 Towards the end of each Academic Session, usually in June each year, you are required to complete an Annual Progress Report, using the on-line system accessed via SPIDER Student Web. The purpose of the report is to ensure that you are making progress as expected but also to ensure that you feel your supervisory arrangements and facilities are satisfactory and give you an opportunity to highlight any difficulties you may be experiencing. You should highlight any issues on these matters clearly in the form to provide retrospective evidence at the end of the studentship for any request for extension or suspension.
- 5.2 The report can only be processed after satisfactory completion of departmental reviews of your progress (see also 5.5 below) which results in a formal recommendation for your re-registration each year. It is therefore essential you complete the form promptly as required. The Progress Reporting System gives numerous email reminders to both students and supervisors. If these are consistently ignored, the University reserves the right to terminate the registration of any student who fails to complete an Annual Progress Report form by 31 August in any year. Failure to complete an annual report by this deadline will therefore result in your registration being terminated.
- 5.3 Annual submission of the Personal Development Record is a pre-requisite for the completion of your Annual Progress Report Form (APRF). An upgrade to PhD or/and re-registration for the next year of research is not possible unless the APRF has been fully processed. Both full-time and part-time students must record a minimum of 8 meetings per academic year. The minimum number of formal meetings required by 31 May in the 1st year of study for students registered at 1 October will be a minimum of 5 and this requirement will be adjusted pro-rata for students who have registered after October (e.g., if your start date was January then a minimum of 3 formal meetings would have to be recorded by the May deadline). For further information, please see the “PDR guidance for students” document <http://www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool/pdfs/PDRGuideStudents.pdf>. If this does not answer all of your questions, contact [PDRgrad@liv.ac.uk](mailto:PDRgrad@liv.ac.uk).
- 5.4 Once you have completed your section of the report, it will be forwarded to your designated Primary Supervisor who will complete it on behalf of the supervisory team. From there, it will be sent to the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research, who completes his/her section and forwards the report to the Graduate School. The Graduate School may refer any issues identified in the report to the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research for comment or action, and then will forward it to the Graduate School with a formal recommendation in respect of your re-registration.
- 5.5 In rare instances where there are serious concerns about a student’s progress, a student will be required to attend a Graduate School Progress Committee which will review the student’s registration and make recommendations regarding progression. In extreme cases, the outcome may constitute the first stage of the formal termination procedure (see Appendix V).
- 5.6 In addition to the Annual Progress Report form, you will also be required to take part in an annual review which will be organised by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. The format of the review will be at the discretion of departments but will involve scrutiny of your progress by an independent panel convened by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. It will normally take place before the Annual Progress Report is completed and its outcome will contribute to the decision as to whether your progress is sufficient to recommend re-registration for the next year of study.
- 5.7 Your Annual Progress Report must be completed by all parties by 30 September so that you are re-registered for the new academic year.
- 5.8 A summary of the formal progress reporting procedure follows:

| Stage         | Informed by                                                      |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student Check | Student checks that the SPIDER web details are correct.          |
| Student       | Student’s own view of progress and recording of any difficulties |

experienced as well as any specific successes. Also the formal meetings with supervisor(s) and other matters recorded in the PDR.

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary Supervisor | Comment on student's report, record own observations and those of fellow supervisors, annual seminar, record of meetings in the PDR.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| DDPR               | View student's and primary supervisor's report and comment if necessary. Detail departmental annual progress monitoring procedures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Graduate School    | View reports from student, primary supervisor and DDPR.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| FDPR               | Used only when required to note and act on any problems or issues identified by the Graduate School. Following the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research's decision the Graduate School either makes a formal recommendation on re-registration or liaises with supervisors/student/DDPR and/or the University Director of Postgraduate Research. |
| Graduate School    | Graduate School recommendation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

5.9 If your thesis has not been submitted by the end of your penultimate permitted year of study, (e.g. by the end of your third full-time year), your supervisors will discuss with you the conditions attached to your re-registration and plan with you a schedule for completion of the thesis. The outcome of this discussion should be part of the Annual Progress Report for that year. Students must be under no illusions that their final permitted year under the Ordinance and Regulations for their degree is their last opportunity to submit the thesis, and must plan and work accordingly.

5.10 It should also be noted that students are required to complete a Progress Report in their final year, even if they anticipate submission.

## 6. Submission Dates – Managing your time – and your supervisory team

6.1 Please refer to the Ordinances and Regulations in Section IV in order to calculate the earliest and latest dates for submission of your thesis. They, plus the following, can only be a GENERAL guide to submission dates according to registration status and will be affected by any periods of suspension so it is essential that you are aware of your own final deadline as registered on the SPIDER student record system.

- MPhil full-time – a minimum of one year and a maximum of four years from the date of first registration.
- MPhil part-time – a minimum of two years and a maximum of six years from the date of first registration.
- MD (part-time only) – a minimum of two years and a maximum of six years from the date of first registration.
- PhD full-time – a minimum of two years and a maximum of four years from the date of first registration.
- PhD part-time – a minimum of four years and a maximum of seven years from the date of first registration.

Students registering under Clause 4 of the PhD Ordinance (Research Assistants) may submit a thesis after a minimum of two years and nine months and a maximum of seven years from the date of first registration.

As indicated above, the maximum permitted times (four years for full-time PhD) are exactly that. You should not expect to use the whole permitted period as the final year is intended as a 'safety net', and you must therefore plan your project to ensure completion of your thesis well before the end of your formal registration.

Extensions are not granted unless there are truly exceptional circumstances beyond your control (such as serious ill health) which delay your submission. Extension requests made on medical grounds must be supported by medical evidence.

If you wish to be considered for an extension to your registration, you must apply using the on-line system which can be accessed via SPIDER Student Web. As previously stated above, there must be truly exceptional circumstances beyond your control. Retrospective applications will not be considered.

6.2 As a postgraduate research student, you are expected to take responsibility for managing your time and your project to ensure timely and successful completion. Your supervisory team is there to provide guidance, support and constructive criticism when required. Your supervisors can only do this effectively if you keep in regular contact, meet with them frequently (all research students, full or part-time, must have at least eight formal, recorded meetings using the PDR every year with their Primary Supervisor and at least three meetings per annum with ALL supervisors) and keep them fully informed of your progress and any problems you may have experienced.

6.3 If your Primary Supervisor is not meeting these requirements or is otherwise failing to discharge the duties required by the University's Code of Practice, you have the right to bring this to the attention of the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research and/or the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research, although you would normally be expected to discuss the situation with your supervisory team in the first instance and attempt to rectify any temporary difficulties locally where possible.

## 7. Suspension of and Extension to Registration

7.1 In exceptional circumstances the University may approve a suspension of registration. A suspension is intended to give you time out if circumstances beyond your control and which are completely unforeseeable (e.g. ill health, maternity leave) mean that you are unable to pursue your research for a period of time. Similarly, extensions will only be considered if there are severe mitigating circumstances (e.g. ill health).

7.2 For the duration of an approved suspension of studies, no fees are raised and students are not permitted to make use of any University facilities. However, you would be expected to make occasional contact with your Primary Supervisor, particularly towards the end of the approved suspension when you must make arrangements to resume your studies.

7.3 There is a formal procedure for suspending studies which can be accessed via the Spider Student Web. Ultimately, the University Director of Postgraduate Research has the authority to approve, or deny, a request for suspension. However, he will only consider a request which is formally supported by your supervisors, department and Faculty and is supported by documents that provide evidence to support your case.

7.4 The process may be represented as follows:

|                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student                                        | Discusses problem with primary supervisor as soon as it becomes apparent and, if the decision is taken to apply for suspension or extension, fills in the application form via the Spider Student Web, providing relevant documentary evidence to support the request. The form is electronically forwarded to the Primary Supervisor. |
| Primary Supervisor                             | Receives the form and provides a statement of support or otherwise. Primary Supervisor forwards the form to the DDPR. The Primary Supervisor should also forward any supporting documents to the DDPR.                                                                                                                                 |
| Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research | Receives the form and if the case is supported provides details of the case and indicates departmental support. Forwards the form to the Graduate School.                                                                                                                                                                              |

- |                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Graduate School                                  | Refers form to the FDPR for approval.                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Faculty Director of PG Research                  | Considers request. If supported, returns form to the Graduate School who forward it to The University Director of Postgraduate Research. If not supported, instructs Graduate School to write on his/her behalf giving reasons for non-support. |
| Graduate School Administrator                    | Refers request to the University Director of Postgraduate Research for approval or otherwise.                                                                                                                                                   |
| University Director of the Postgraduate Research | Considers request and the decision is communicated to the student. If approved, GS Administrator writes on his behalf to the student. If refused, the case is usually referred back to the Graduate School with an explanation of the refusal.  |
- 7.5 To reiterate, you must discuss whether a suspension of studies would be appropriate with your supervisors as soon as you feel you are experiencing difficulties which will prevent you carrying out your research. Suspensions are NEVER approved retrospectively.
- 7.6 If your request for a suspension is on the grounds of ill health, it will not be considered without a doctor's certificate.
- 7.7 If you are externally sponsored, your Primary Supervisor will need to seek the agreement of your sponsor separately as well as the University authorities.
8. Submission and Examination of your thesis
- 8.1 At least two months before you expect to submit your thesis, you should complete a 'Notice of Intention to Submit' form, which is available from the Graduate School website and forward it to your Primary Supervisor. Your supervisory team will make recommendations to the Head of Department or DDPR in respect of appointing your examiners. Please note that failure to complete this form in good time will delay your examination. You will not be able to submit your thesis if you have not obtained at least 180 credits for skills and research training or have a completed form from your department indicating that you have cleared your work space all your belongings.
- 8.2 You must submit three copies of your thesis for examination. Your thesis may be presented for examination:
- Bound in book form with stiff covers; the title of the work shall be shown on the front cover and the candidate's surname, initials, degree and the year on the spine.
  - In a secure temporary binding, by which is meant that the thesis should be presented in such a way that the pages cannot be readily removed (therefore, ring binders and spiral binders are not permitted), bearing the title of the work on the front cover, together with the candidate's surname, initials, degree and the year.
- 8.3 You formally submit your thesis to the Student Administration Centre. Please be aware that you are still required to submit three hard copies of your thesis for submission to the examiners appointed to assess your thesis. The requirement for submission of an electronic copy of your thesis (see Section 9 below) applies to the final approved version of your thesis. You must also complete a 'Submission of Thesis' form which is vital, as it gives the University due notice that you expect to graduate – if you do not complete it, you will not be included in arrangements for a Graduation Ceremony. (You will not be allowed to graduate unless all debts to the University have been paid.). You will also be provided with an information sheet detailing what will happen next in the time leading up to your examination date. The University expects all examiners to conduct the *VIVA VOCE* examination within 3 months of submission of your thesis.

8.4 An oral examination is compulsory for MD, MPhil and PhD students, and may be required for other degrees. You must bring a copy of your thesis with you to the oral examination.

8.5 For general guidance, the Ordinance for the degree of PhD states that the degree may be conferred upon:

A graduate of this or any other approved University or Institution, or a candidate who holds a qualification deemed by the Senate to be equivalent to an Honours degree of this University, who has submitted a thesis embodying the results of his/her individual research which is adjudged to make an original contribution to learning; which is coherently structured and clearly presented; and which shows evidence of systematic study and of ability to relate the results of such study to the general body of knowledge in the subject...

NB: Graduate: For the purpose of this Ordinance, applicants for the degree of PhD who are holders of degrees awarded by the Council for National Academic Awards are treated on the same footing as graduates of an approved university.

A PhD candidate would meet the criterion of originality by, for instance, discovering new knowledge, or connecting previously unrelated facts, or developing a new theory, or revising established views. (The ordinance for the degree of MD contains a similar criterion relating to originality.) In considering whether a thesis has met all the requirements of the relevant Ordinance, Examiners should base their judgement on what may reasonably be expected of an able and diligent research student after completing the appropriate period of research required for the degree. They may also wish to satisfy themselves that the thesis contains material worthy of publication.

8.6 Unless appointed as an Internal Examiner under Regulations 9 and 20 of the Ordinance for the degree of Master of Philosophy or Regulations 10 and 22 of the Ordinance for the degree of Doctor in Philosophy, supervisors cannot be present at the oral examination.

8.7 The Examiners will prepare independent written reports on the thesis before any oral examination, and a formal joint report, with an agreed recommendation after the oral examination. If the Examiners are unable to reach agreement on their recommendation, an additional External Examiner may be appointed, who shall be required to act independently of the other Examiners.

8.8 The Examiners may recommend:

- the immediate award of the degree (note that trivial corrections that can be completed in no more than one day are allowable within this recommendation);
- the award of the degree after minor modifications, which should be made to the satisfaction of the Examiners, and within a time limit, imposed by the Examiners (not more than three months). The Internal Examiner will normally take responsibility for ensuring that the minor modifications have been completed satisfactorily;
- major revision and re-submission of the thesis (if this recommendation is used, the Examiners should state, if appropriate, whether a further oral examination should be held on re-examination of the thesis);
- in the case of PhD candidates, the award of a lower degree (with or without minor amendments or major revision to the thesis);
- that the degree be not awarded (outright failure).

8.9 A dissertation, thesis, essay, project or any other work which is not undertaken in an examination room under supervision, but which is submitted by a student for formal assessment during his/her course of study, must be written by the candidate himself and in his/her own words, except for quotations from published and unpublished sources which shall be clearly indicated and acknowledged as such. The incorporation of material from other works or a paraphrase of such material without acknowledgement will be treated as plagiarism, subject to the custom and usage of the subject. The source of any photograph, map or other illustration shall also be indicated as shall the source, published or unpublished, of any material not resulting from the candidate's own experimentation, observation or specimen-collecting. (Extracted from *Regulations for the Conduct of Examinations*, © The University of Liverpool.) Details of the procedures for dealing with suspected cases of plagiarism are contained in section 5 of the same Regulations, which may be found on the University's website as follows:

[http://www.liv.ac.uk/sas/administration/regs\\_conduct\\_exams.pdf](http://www.liv.ac.uk/sas/administration/regs_conduct_exams.pdf)

Where the Examiners' report and recommendation indicates that the degree is to be awarded, it is considered by the Board of the Faculty and then forwarded to the Senate Committee for the Award of Degrees, Diplomas and Certificates for ratification.

8.10 The process may be represented as follows:

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student                        | At least two months before expected submission date, completes Intention to Submit form and forwards to Primary Supervisor.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Primary Supervisor             | Nominates Examiners and forwards form to DDPR/HOD.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| DDPR/HOD                       | Endorses Examiners and forwards form to the Graduate School.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Graduate School                | Approves Examiners.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Graduate School                | Writes formally to the appointed Examiners.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Student                        | Submits thesis, in temporary binding, to Student Administration Centre.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Graduate School                | Ensures Intention to Submit form has been completed and that Examiners have been appointed, that student has minimum number of credits and asks student to complete "Submission of a Thesis" form.<br>Circulates thesis to Examiners.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Internal Examiner              | Arranges viva.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Internal and External Examiner | Complete "Initial Report of the Examiners" forms in advance of the viva (these are then held by the Internal Examiner).<br>After the viva, the "Final Report of the Examiners" form is completed, signed and forwarded immediately, together with the signed initial reports, to the Graduate School (copies should be sent to the appropriate DDPR).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Graduate School                | Checks reports and: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• if recommendation is for award of degree without need for amendments to the thesis – asks appropriate FDPR to approve recommendation. Reports are then sent to SAS.</li> <li>• If recommendation is for award of degree with minor modifications to the thesis – writes to Internal Examiner stating that modifications must be completed and signed off within three months of the date of the viva. When done, asks appropriate FDPR to approve recommendation. Reports are then sent to SAS.</li> <li>• If resubmission or outright failure – asks FDPR to approve recommendation and then writes to the student confirming the recommendation following consideration by the University Director of Postgraduate Research.</li> </ul> |
| SAS                            | Seeks approval from Committee for the Award of Degrees, Diplomas and Certificates (NB Student must submit copy of final version of thesis to the Graduate School for deposit in the University Library before approval of the recommendation can be sought).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## 9. Intellectual Property Rights, Copyright and Deposit of the Thesis in the Library

9.1 Except in the case of students supported by outside bodies (including the Research Councils), where specific provisions relating to intellectual property are embodied in the conditions of the support, all postgraduate students are required to agree to assign to the University all their rights to intellectual



property arising from their studies or research at the University, to be managed by the University in accordance with its normal custom and practice. The University has a policy of sharing any profits arising from the exploitation of the results of research with the staff and research students concerned.

- 9.2 A copy of the thesis submitted by a candidate and approved as fulfilling the requirements for the award of a postgraduate research degree in the University will be retained by the University and deposited for safe custody in the University Library.

PGR students who register after 1 August 2008 will be required to submit an electronic copy of any thesis or dissertation submitted and approved as fulfilling the requirements for a higher degree or doctorate for retention by the University and held in the University Repository. Students will be required to submit an electronic copy of the final version of their thesis to the University Repository as soon as it has been approved by the Examiners.

PGR students whose start date is before 1 August 2008 may, if they so wish, submit an electronic copy of their thesis which has been approved as fulfilling the requirements for a higher degree or doctorate for retention by the University and held in the University repository.

- 9.3 Any copyright that may be vested in the candidate will not be affected thereby. Access to theses deposited in the Library and copies thereof will normally be available to *bona fide* enquirers, but authors will be permitted to impose restrictions on access and copying annually for up to five years if the Head of Department, after consultation with the candidate's supervisor, endorses the author's statement that preparation for publication, or some other good reason, requires such a restriction. In the event of such restriction being imposed, the abstract of the thesis will be made available for copying to *bona fide* enquirers and to the publishers of abstracts of theses.
- 9.4 No candidate may be prevented, by the terms of a contract from an outside sponsor or any other means, from including in a thesis submitted for a higher degree all material relevant to the research project and from being examined upon it. If material of a confidential nature is included in a thesis, obligations of confidentiality may be imposed upon the Examiners and the author may restrict access to the thesis deposited in the Library as provided for above.

## 10. Key Points for Part-time Postgraduate Research Students

- 10.1 The University of Liverpool and its Graduate School strives to ensure that all postgraduate research students, regardless of their mode of study, receive the support and environment they need to complete their research degrees successfully and in good time. Therefore, the majority of the standards and procedures set out in this Handbook and its Codes of Practice make no distinction between full-time and part-time students. However, in recognition of the fact that part-time postgraduates do have specific needs and concerns, this section summarises key points for part-time students.

### 10.2 Applying for Admission

Applicants for part-time places for postgraduate study are strongly advised to think carefully about their applications. Given the extended timescales (up to seven years) for completion of a PhD, an application should include a research proposal which is achievable over this timescale. In addition, given that full-time study is the norm at Liverpool, applicants should make clear why they wish to study part-time and how their other commitments would be managed to give adequate time for the research.

### 10.3 Registration and Fees

Registration requirements, including making arrangements to pay fees (or providing evidence of sponsorship) are the same as for full-time students.

### 10.4 Induction

It is recognised that part-time students are less likely to be able to attend the formal departmental induction

(normally held in the first term of each academic year). However, part-time students can expect to be given full access to departmental handbooks and should arrange an early meeting with the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research in addition to their supervisors.

#### 10.5 Skills Programme

Part-time students are expected to satisfy the same requirements overall as full-time students in respect of the amount of Skills Training they must complete. However, as every postgraduate completes, with their Primary Supervisor, a Skills Audit, their training needs can be tailored to their experience and appropriate exemptions granted from individual training components. They are also required to complete a Personal Development Record (PDR) as part of the Skills Programme and to complete a PDR every year prior to the Annual Progress Monitoring procedure. It is possible for part-time students to amass 180 credits via satisfactory completion of the PDR alone. However, the credit target is a MINIMUM of 180 credits and must include at least 90 credits from the PDR and attendance at the compulsory First Year Skills Workshop, Careers Skills Workshop and Poster Day.

There is an online version of the First year Skills Workshop available for all part-time students as an alternative to the First Year Skills Workshop.

#### 10.6 Annual Progress Monitoring

The requirements in respect of Annual Progress Reports and re-registration are exactly the same as for full-time students. The University's web-based Progress Reporting system can be completed off-site and is therefore very convenient for part-time students to use.

#### 10.7 Managing Time

The University has a minimum requirement, audited through the PDR and Annual Progress Reports, that postgraduates meet with their Primary Supervisor on average once per calendar month. This applies to part-time as well as full-time students, as the University believes that such a commitment is the least necessary to ensure timely and successful completion. (Normally, it is expected that full-time students meet their supervisors more often.)

It is vital, given the longer period of research, that momentum is maintained. Part-time students are strongly encouraged to use the PDR and other mechanisms to plan their time. No special treatment is given to part-time students in respect of extensions to submission time.

#### 10.8 Submission and Examination

The requirements are identical to those of full-time students. Any student may check their registration details using SPIDER web, which can be accessed remotely via the University web site.

## SECTION II: Information for University Staff

### Introduction

This section of the handbook is intended to provide detailed procedural guidance to all University staff involved in the supervision, management and administration of postgraduate research students. It should be read in conjunction with the Codes of Practice relating to Postgraduate Research and the Ordinances and Regulations for the various postgraduate degrees by research.

### 11. Admissions Procedures and the Appointment of Supervisors

11.1 As outlined in the University's Code of Practice for the Selection and Admission of Research Students (See Section III), the primary responsibility in terms of the Admission of research students is vested in the academic department.

11.2 An outline of the Admissions Process is as follows:

- (i) Formal application made by student.
- (ii) Application received by UKSRO (Postgraduate Team). Initial processing, SPIDER record created, applicant sent a Fees Questionnaire where not obviously 'home' in order to determine fee status. Application acknowledged in writing, then sent to Department.
- (iii) Department receives application. Normally this is sent to the Postgraduate Admissions Tutor/Officer, who should refer it to the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. An initial assessment of the candidate is made, to decide if the proposed research can be supported by the department and whether the candidate is suitable for admission. At this stage, potential supervisors are identified.
- (iv) References are requested by the Department.
- (v) The candidate is interviewed, either in person or, where this is not practical, by telephone. At least two members of the academic staff should be involved in interviewing the candidate. One of these will normally be the proposed Primary Supervisor. However, there must be independent scrutiny of the application and the candidate, normally by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research or a senior academic nominee, who must participate in the interview for this purpose.
- (vi) The Head of Department or Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research (as his/her nominee) is formally responsible for approving the supervisory team. Where he/she has concerns, the nominations should be referred back to the Head of Department for alternative supervisors. Supervisors must have completed a Supervisor Good Practice Workshop to be eligible to supervise research students, regardless of previous experience.
- (vii) Where the department wishes to accept the candidate, they should notify UKSRO (Faculty Office for clinical Faculties) of any conditions and instruct UKSRO/Faculty Office) to issue a formal offer. Where the candidate is to be rejected, the applicant should be notified in writing and UKSRO/Faculty Office informed.

### 12. Registration and Induction

12.1 The first thing a student must do on arrival at the University is register formally, by completing a Registration form in the appropriate departmental office. This ensures that their presence is formally recorded and they are fully insured to carry out research on the University's premises. It also ensures that they receive their University ID card quickly and are able to access Library and Computing facilities.

- 12.2 In addition, the registration form contains details of the supervisors for input onto SPIDER. This will ensure that the relevant departments receive the credit for the student's registration.
- 12.3 In accordance with the Ordinances and Regulations for Research Degrees, students MUST register at the start of their research degree. Backdated registration is not permitted.
- 12.4 The student must attend departmental and/or Graduate School induction programmes offered. Where the student registers mid-session, the supervisors will ensure that appropriate information on the Department and Faculty is provided. Students must be informed at the outset of the vital importance of using their University email account regularly.
13. Defining the Research Topic in Detail
- 13.1 Supervisors have a responsibility to ensure that any delay in determining the topic is kept to a minimum and that the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research is kept informed of any problems.
- 13.2 The following factors should be taken into account in determining the programme of work for individual candidates:
- (i) Whether, on the information available, the proposed programme of work is capable of being studied to the depth required to obtain the degree for which the candidate is to be registered.
  - (ii) Whether it might reasonably be expected that the programme of work could be completed within the timescale designated for it.
  - (iii) Whether, in so far as can be predicted, the appropriate necessary resources (e.g. library, computing, laboratory facilities, technical assistance) will be available.
  - (iv) Whether it is expected that proper supervision can be provided, and can be maintained throughout the research period, including any periods of study leave for the Primary Supervisor or time spent by the student away from Liverpool.
14. Skills Training and the Personal Development Record
- 14.1 All research students are required to complete a Skills Training Programme as part of their research degree (although they may be given exemption from specified parts of it, based on prior learning or experience, at the discretion of Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research).
- 14.2 As a first step, supervisors must assist the student in undertaking a Skills Audit (the student accesses this using the Personal Development Record software). This will enable all concerned to identify the Skills Training required by the student in addition to the mandatory workshops.
15. Meetings of Students and Supervisors
- 15.1 All research students must have a minimum of eight formal (recorded) meetings with their Primary Supervisor per annum, and at least one formal meeting with the supervisory team once per term. These meetings must be formally planned and recorded, using the Personal Development Record software.
- 15.2 The student begins by suggesting both an agenda and targets for the formal meeting and uses the software to send this to the supervisor. This forms the basis of the meeting. During the meeting, the student and supervisor(s) agree the outcomes and targets, and these are formally signed off by the supervisor in their TULIP account. This then forms the agreed formal log of meetings, the dates of which will be stated in the Annual Progress Report each year. Notes for Guidance for supervisors on entering information and completing the PDR can be obtained from the Graduate School website.
- 15.3 It is expected that in most cases, students and supervisors will meet more frequently than this. These meetings may be informal or formal and recorded as required. Special arrangements apply to students

registered off-site in accordance with the Code of Practice.

16. Annual Progress Monitoring

16.1 The Annual Progress Monitoring procedure has two parts: firstly, the student must be given an opportunity to present an oral report on the year's work, in accordance with arrangements made by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. Secondly, progress and re-registration is formally recorded using the Annual Progress Report form.

16.2 The report must be checked for data accuracy and then completed by the student, then by the Primary Supervisor (or designated supervisor) on behalf of the supervisory team, then by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research, then by the Graduate School.

16.3 The workflow may be summarised thus:

| Stage              | Informed by                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student Check      | SPIDER web details                                                                                                                                          |
| Student            | Student's own view of progress and any difficulties experienced as well as any specific successes. Also the meetings and other matters recorded in the PDR. |
| Primary Supervisor | Student's report, own observations and those of fellow supervisors, annual seminar, record of meetings in the PDR.                                          |
| DDPR               | Student's and supervisors' report, annual seminar.                                                                                                          |
| Graduate School    | Reports from student, supervisory team and DDPR.                                                                                                            |
| FDPR               | As Graduate School, used only when required. Graduate School make formal recommendation on re-registration taking account of all previous stages.           |
| Graduate School    | Graduate School recommendation.                                                                                                                             |

16.4 The Annual Progress Report form is the basis for re-registration each new academic session. If it is not completed by 30 September in any year, the University reserves the right to terminate registration and/or withhold funding from the department/budget centre in respect of the student concerned (on an FTE basis).

16.5 Where a supervisor or the department has concerns over the student's academic progress, the Progress Report form can be used as the first stage of the formal Termination Procedure described in Appendix V of this handbook.

17. Suspensions of Studies, Extension of Registration and Changes from Full-time to Part-time Registration

17.1 Where a student is prevented from carrying on with their research degree as a result of serious circumstances beyond their own control, e.g. serious ill health, they should be advised to seek an immediate suspension of studies. Supervisors and departments must support students in this, and are expected to be proactive in discussing such problems with the student. Where suspension is sought on medical grounds, medical evidence must be obtained and submitted.

17.2 Where a student considers that circumstances beyond their control (e.g. illness, family) have affected their progress, they may submit an application for an extension beyond their last permitted submission date. As in 16.1 above, supervisors and departments must support students in this and are expected to be proactive in discussing such problems with the student. Where extension requests are made on medical grounds,

medical evidence must be obtained and submitted. All extension requests must be accompanied by a detailed plan, with milestones, for the submission of the thesis within the requested extension period.

In accordance with University rules and regulations, applications for extensions of time must be **made at least thirty days before the student's last permitted submission date.**

- 17.3 A student who wishes to transfer his/her registration from full-time to part-time will be required to produce evidence which certifies that they are no longer able to continue their studies on a full-time basis (e.g. an offer of full-time employment, a letter from social services certifying that the student cares for a relative on a full-time basis). Requests for transfer from full-time to part-time which are made on financial grounds will not be considered. Transfers from full-time to part-time registration requested after more than two years of full-time registration will not be considered under any circumstances.

A full-time student may, during the course of their study, be appointed to a position as a Research Assistant in the University, which will require them to transfer from full-time to part-time registration. Please be aware that a transfer is not automatic and it is the responsibility of the student to request a transfer to part-time registration via the procedure described below.

- 17.4 A summary of the approval process for such changes follows:

|                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student                                          | Discusses situation with supervisor as soon as it becomes apparent.                                                                                                                             |
| Primary Supervisor                               | Discusses situation with Student, other supervisors and makes a formal request in writing to the DDPR in the first instance.                                                                    |
| DDPR                                             | Considers request, with further discussions with student/supervisors as necessary. If supported, forwards case to the Faculty Office.                                                           |
| Graduate School                                  | Refers request to Faculty Director of PG Research.                                                                                                                                              |
| FDPR                                             | Considers request. If supported, Graduate School instructed to forward it to UDPR. If not supported, Graduate School writes to the department on his/her behalf giving reasons for non-support. |
| Graduate School                                  | Refers request to University Director of Postgraduate Research.                                                                                                                                 |
| University Director of the Postgraduate Research | Considers request. If approved, GS Administrator writes on his behalf to the student. If refused, the case is usually referred back to the FSU/FO with an explanation of the refusal.           |

- 17.5 When formulating an application for suspension, extension or transfer to part-time, students must not assume, or be given the impression, that approval is automatic. Departmental Directors, Faculty Directors and the University Director of Postgraduate Research are empowered to refuse weak and late requests submitted in any of these categories.

## 18. Submission and Examination of the Thesis

- 18.1 The supervisory team is responsible for ensuring that the student submits the thesis within the time prescribed by the Ordinances and Regulations for the degree concerned. The normal expectation is that a full-time student would complete research for an MPhil within two years and a PhD within three years.
- 18.2 The Primary Supervisor should ensure that, at least two months prior to submission of the thesis, the student has obtained and completed a 'Notification of Intention to Submit' form from the Graduate School and forwarded it to the Primary Supervisor to commence the process of appointing examiners.
- 18.3 The specific responsibilities relating to examinations and examiners are described in the relevant Code of

Practice (Section III of this handbook). The following guidelines are drawn from the Ordinances and Regulations for the degree of PhD.

- (i) Supervisors will present to the Head of Department a list of potential nominees for appointment as examiners by the Board of the Faculty (via the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research).
- (ii) There should be a minimum of two Examiners to assess a thesis. There shall always be an Internal Examiner and an External Examiner. The supervisor should not normally be appointed as the Internal Examiner. When, exceptionally, a supervisor is appointed as the Internal Examiner, a second External Examiner should be appointed.
- (iii) Under the provision of University Statutes, External Examiners shall not be 'members of the academic staff of the University'.

## 19. Reports and Recommendations of Examiners

### 19.1 It is the duty of the Internal Examiner to:

- (i) Co-ordinate all arrangements relating to the examination of the candidate, including the oral examination.
- (ii) Ensure that initial reports of both examiners are completed before the examination takes place.
- (iii) Ensure that the initial and final reports of the Examiners are submitted to the Graduate School as soon as possible after the examination and assessment of the thesis has been completed, normally immediately after the oral examination.
- (iv) Ensure that the candidate's Head of Department receives a copy of the report and recommendation of the Examiners.
- (v) Ensure that the candidate is provided with information on the substantive points arising from the examination, and if the candidate is required to make a re-submission for the degree ensure that a clear set of guidelines on the revisions required to bring the thesis up to the required standard is provided.
- (vi) Ensure that when the examination process is completed and all necessary corrections to the thesis have been made by the candidate, the final report of the Examiners and a copy of the thesis in permanent binding is sent to the Faculty Office. This copy of the thesis will be deposited in the University Library.

### 19.2 It is the normal expectation of the University that the initial examination of a thesis and an oral examination shall be completed within three months of submission.

### 19.3 After consideration of the Examiners' report and recommendation by the appropriate Board of the Faculty the recommendation is forwarded to the Senate Committee for the Award of Degrees, Diplomas and Certificates, in the case of a successful application for the degree.

### 19.4 When the Examiners of an application for a postgraduate degree by research recommend that a thesis should be revised and re-submitted, or that a lower degree be awarded, or recommend that a degree should not be awarded, their report and recommendation is also referred to the Board of the Faculty. Graduate School will write to the student after the report and recommendation has been fully reviewed.

When the Examiners' recommend that a thesis should be resubmitted, this must be done within one year from the date of the viva. From 1 October 2008, students in this category will not have to complete an Annual Progress Report. However, the Internal Examiner, with support from the Primary Supervisor, must monitor progress to completion of the revised thesis every three months.

## SECTION III: Codes of Practice and Frameworks for Postgraduate Research Degrees

### 20. General Introduction

A major duty of the University is the advancement of knowledge through pursuit of research. Postgraduate students, both full-time and part-time, are accepted by the University so that they may acquire the skills of research and make their own contribution to the advancement of knowledge.

The following Codes of Practice relate to postgraduate research at the University of Liverpool:

- Code of Practice on the Selection and Admission of postgraduate research students
- Code of Practice on Research Student Supervision (including the responsibilities of students)
- Code of Practice for the Directors of Postgraduate Research
- Code of Practice on research degree examinations and Examiners
- Code of Practice for Registration away from the main campus (off-site)

Taken together, the Codes provide a framework of minimum standards of practice required by the University in the management of postgraduate research. They therefore apply to research students, supervisors and all staff of the University who have an involvement with postgraduate research students.

In addition, the following frameworks have been approved in respect of postgraduate research students who are registered for Research Master's and Professional Doctorate programmes:

- Framework for Research Master's Programmes.
- Framework for Professional Doctorates

### 21. Code of Practice on the Selection and Admission of Research Students

21.1 In order not to encourage false expectations, the advertising and promotional information provided by the University on research opportunities will be clear and comprehensive and include general guidance on the following:

- The personal, professional and educational experience and qualifications required for admission as a postgraduate student of the University, including any English Language requirements;
- The time normally required for completion of a research degree and the level of commitment required;
- The resources, including supervision and support services, that are made available to research students;
- Current levels of fees;
- The various stages of registration, e.g. admission, initial registration, annual monitoring, upgrade from MPhil to PhD etc.;

21.2 In order for the University to discharge its obligations under the Disability Discrimination Act, promotional materials will indicate any instances where research programmes are not suitable for a student with special needs e.g. disability. If possible suitable alternative research programmes will be indicated.

21.3 The University will indicate in promotional material how long applications for admission should normally take to be considered.

21.4 There must be at least two members of staff involved in making a decision on admission. At least one member of staff involved in the admission process should be a senior member of the Department, normally the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. At least one person involved in the decision must not be a member of the proposed supervisory team. All involved must have sufficient experience to assess the suitability of applicants.

21.5 The selection process must normally involve an interview with the applicant. However, in cases where this



is not possible, a telephone discussion may be sufficient or the Department should have in place a clearly-documented alternative procedure which allows it to assess adequately the suitability of applicants. In any case, the process must include independent scrutiny of the application documents, including references, by the Director of Graduate Studies or a senior colleague who is not part of the proposed supervision team.

- 21.6 When considering applications from candidates with special needs, thought should be given as to whether an adequate support infrastructure exists within the institution. However, those with special needs will be considered for admission on the same academic grounds as other applicants (see also the University's "Guide to Support and Services for Disabled Students", available online at <http://www.liv.ac.uk/student services/dsconts.htm>).
- 21.7 References (normally two) must be obtained which comment on the suitability of the applicant to undertake research.
- 21.8 Confirmation of the applicant's qualifications must be sought and admissions staff must be satisfied that they are genuine, seeking advice from colleagues in the Student Recruitment offices as necessary.
- 21.9 A clear indication of the ability of the candidate to pay the required fees and appropriate expenses must be obtained.
- 21.10 Once a decision has been made on whether or not an applicant is acceptable the reasons must be recorded. Relevant Departmental and Graduate School staff should be informed of the decision, as should other interested stakeholders (for example, Research Councils, industrial partners etc.).
- 21.11 If the candidate is admitted, a formal offer letter must be sent from SRAO which will include the following information:
- nature of the research project and the department or unit within which it will be based;
  - supervision arrangements;
  - proposed start date and period within which the thesis must be completed;
  - all relevant financial information, including bench fees/research support costs;
  - the date by which the candidate should confirm (or otherwise) acceptance of the offer;
  - any other relevant conditions relating to the offer e.g. English language requirements;
  - brief details of the Skills Training requirements.

## 22. Code of Practice on Research Student Supervision

### 22.1 General

- (i) Arrangements for supervision of research students will be made by Heads of Departments, in the first instance, who will be responsible for overseeing the supervision received by students. However, all nominations of supervisory teams must also be approved by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research. Where a Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research identifies a potential problem with a proposed supervisor, the matter should be referred to the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research (NB: In the Faculty of Medicine, the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research formally approves ALL supervisory arrangements, rather than Departmental Directors of Postgraduate Research). All research students must have a clearly identified Primary Supervisor, who will normally be their main point of contact, as well as at least one additional supervisor (these will be known as 'Second', 'Third' Supervisor etc).
- (ii) The Primary Supervisor will normally be a full-time member of academic staff of the University. In certain instances, the Primary Supervisor with the most appropriate subject expertise will not be a member of full-time academic staff. In such instances, departments must ensure that the Second Supervisor is a member of full-time academic staff and must be satisfied that continued supervision of the research student can be maintained for the duration of the research degree.
- (iii) When appointing supervisors, departments are required to give an indication of the level of their

respective input by expressing this as a percentage. For example, where two supervisors have an equal input, this would be recorded as a ratio of 50:50. Alternatively, the Primary Supervisor might contribute the vast majority of effort to supervision and the Second Supervisor have a largely pastoral, supporting role, in which case the record might show a ratio of 90:10. Other combinations are, of course, possible but the department must ensure that this information is recorded (on SPIDER).

- (iv) Members of academic staff may only be appointed as a supervisor to a research student if they are currently research active, as indicated by, for example, the criteria of the Research Assessment Exercise. In addition, they must also have completed a Supervisor Good Practice Workshop.

NB: Supervisors of MD students should be members of University staff and hold a higher degree. A member of NHS staff may only supervise an MD student if they hold a University of Liverpool Honorary Appointment and have a higher degree. At least one supervisor for every MD student must be a full-time member of the academic staff of the University.

- (v) The nature of research is such that no supervisor should undertake the supervision of more than a limited number of students. Although it is recognised that practice can vary by discipline, no member of staff should normally be a Primary Supervisor to more than eight students. Exceptions to this rule can only be made at the discretion of the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research.
- (vi) In cases where a supervisor leaves the University, or is unable to continue supervision for whatever reason, the matter should be considered by the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research who will, in consultation with the student, recommend to the Head of Department an alternative supervisor. The Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research is responsible for drawing the Head of Department's attention to any problems that may occur as a result of staff changes.
- (vii) If, for any reason, there is a breakdown in the personal relationship between a student and a supervisor, or if a student feels that progress is not being maintained at a satisfactory level, for reasons beyond his/her control, the matter should be discussed. Students are here reminded of the many avenues available to discuss any issues or problems they may have regarding supervision or registration. Students are encouraged to discuss such matters with their supervisors or, if necessary, their Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research or the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research. In addition, a student may bring up any difficulties with supervision in the Annual Progress report on the section of the form specifically designed for that purpose.

## 22.2 Duties and Responsibilities of Primary Supervisors

NB: Students who registered for MD before 1 September 1999 will have an 'adviser' in place of a supervisor. However, for the purposes of this Code, the MD adviser is treated as a Primary Supervisor.

Primary Supervisors, whether at the University or one of its accredited Colleges, have the following Duties and Responsibilities under this Code:

- (i) To ensure that students are familiar with the Codes of Practice and the Ordinances and Regulations that govern research degrees.
- (ii) To ensure that students are aware of the current developments in both specific and wider areas of research.
- (iii) To ensure that students, in consultation with Departmental Directors of Postgraduate Research, complete the required Skills training, commencing with a Skills Audit which must be completed in consultation with the student and all supervisors.
- (iv) To ensure that students complete their Personal Development Record annually, and indicating on the Annual Progress Report that this has been satisfactorily completed according to agreed targets.
- (v) To give guidance about the planning of the research programme. A draft programme of work

should be agreed by the student and supervisor at the outset, with indicative deadlines for completion of the stages of the research programme.

- (vi) To give guidance about literature and sources, about requisite techniques (arranging for instruction where necessary) and about the problem of plagiarism.
- (vii) To ensure that at least eight formal meetings takes place with the research student each year, with an agenda agreed in advance (using the Personal Development Record software) and an agreed record of outcomes and targets following the meeting, which must be recorded.
- (viii) To be accessible to students as appropriate at times other than formal meetings. The expectation is that they will meet frequently with students on an informal basis.
- (ix) To convene a meeting of the student and all supervisors at least once per term, (three times per year). Primary Supervisors are responsible for arranging this meeting and ensuring the outcomes are recorded.
- (x) To encourage students to question critically the existing literature, the assumptions of the research project and the results they obtain.
- (xi) To arrange for students to talk about their work to staff or at graduate seminars and to have practice in oral examinations and to encourage students to communicate their findings to others in the academic community. Where appropriate students should be encouraged to attend and contribute to conferences.
- (xii) To ensure that students are made aware of inadequacy of progress or of standards of work below those generally expected. (Constructive criticism is an important role of the Primary Supervisor.)
- (xiii) To ensure that the particular needs of overseas students are taken fully into account during the early stages of research and to give help and advice on language problems and training where necessary.
- (xiv) To ensure that Annual Progress Reports are completed in accordance with the University procedure, to complete the relevant section of the report on behalf of the supervisory team and to ensure that students re-register promptly at the beginning of each session.
- (xv) To ensure that appropriate and timely recommendations in terms of changes to registration are made, e.g. upgrade to PhD or change to Submission Pending. This may be done either as part of the Annual Progress Report or separately if in mid-session.
- (xvi) To ensure that a draft of the thesis is read within an agreed timescale and suitable feedback given in good time to ensure submission.
- (xvii) To ensure that any circumstances that might require a student's formal registration to be amended or suspended are brought to the attention of the Graduate School, via the DDPR, immediately (e.g. changes to part-time, suspensions of study, upgrades to PhD, changes to Submission Pending).
- (xviii) To assist the Head of Department with the selection of the Examiners, to inform the student of the names of the Examiners and to ensure that the student is prepared and supported for the oral examination.

### 22.3 Duties and Responsibilities of Second and other Supervisors

Staff appointed as Second (or Third etc) Supervisors have the following Duties and Responsibilities:

- (i) To consult with the Primary Supervisor on the feasibility of the proposed project and the suitability of the student to undertake the research, before formal registration and in an initial meeting of the student and all supervisors.
- (ii) To assist the student and Primary Supervisor in completing a Skills Audit at the beginning of the student's first year.
- (iii) To meet with the student and all members of the supervisory team at least once per term (three times per year), to discuss progress and the direction the research is taking. There should be a

formal record of these meetings retained by the Student in the Personal Development Record and by the Primary Supervisor in TULIP. Second Supervisors are encouraged to keep a copy of this record.

- (iv) To be available at times other than formal meetings and provide general support as required to the student and the Primary Supervisor. The level of such involvement will vary, in accordance with the expected contribution agreed at the outset. In some cases, the role of the Second Supervisor will be a largely pastoral, supporting one, but in other cases the Second Supervisor will make an important academic input which would give rise to an expectation for a greater frequency of contact. This should be agreed with the student and the Primary Supervisor.
- (v) To discuss with the Primary Supervisor any formal recommendations relating to the student's registration, such as suspension of studies, transfer from MPhil to PhD (and vice versa) and to 'submission pending' status.
- (vi) To discuss with the Primary Supervisor the student's progress as part of the Annual Progress Monitoring exercise.
- (vii) To assist in the nomination of examiners.

#### 22.4 Duties and Responsibilities of Postgraduate Research Students

In addition to the general responsibilities described in the University's Student Charter, postgraduate research students have the following duties and responsibilities under this Code of Practice:

- (i) To agree a programme of work with all supervisors at the beginning of their first year and to review this at appropriate intervals in each academic year in consultation with the supervisors, ensuring that any deviation from the agreed programme is reported to supervisors without delay.
- (ii) To familiarise themselves with the relevant Ordinances and Regulations governing their degrees and the requirements imposed on them by those Ordinances and Regulations.
- (iii) To ensure that their obligations to their sponsors and funding bodies are met by the timely submission of the thesis, and to meet any other requirements imposed by the conditions of sponsorship.
- (iv) To devote the appropriate time and effort to their studies. Full-time students are expected to spend a minimum of 35 hours per week engaged in research (including formal skills training), normally on the University campus. Part-time students are expected to devote an average of 16 hours per week to their studies.
- (v) To ensure that they undertake a Skills Audit using the Personal Development Record at the outset of their programme, in consultation with all supervisors and complete the required skills training as agreed with their supervisors.
- (vi) To check their University email account on a regular basis and act promptly on messages received from the University.
- (vii) To maintain a Personal Development Record throughout the duration of their research degree.
- (viii) To take the initiative in raising problems or difficulties, however elementary they may seem and to ensure that any circumstances that are impeding their progress are brought to the attention of their supervisors at the earliest opportunity.
- (ix) To discuss with supervisors the type of guidance and comment they find most helpful and to agree a schedule of meetings. There must be at least one formal meeting per month.
- (x) In advance of each formal meeting, to complete an agenda using the Personal Development Record software and to send this to their Primary Supervisor. Following the meeting, the agreed outcomes and targets must also be recorded in the Personal Development Record.
- (xi) To maintain the progress of work in accordance with the stages agreed with supervisors, including in particular the presentation of written work as required in sufficient time to allow for comments and discussion before proceeding to the next stage.

- (xii) To complete the University's Annual Progress Report form in good time to ensure re-registration at the beginning of the new academic session, and to complete other progress reports required.
- (xiii) To communicate research findings to others in the academic community, formally in the annual seminar as part of the Annual Progress Monitoring procedure, and at other opportunities as agreed with the supervisors.
- (xiv) Before submission, to clear any laboratory area in which they have been working, including the safe disposal of surplus chemicals and other materials.
- (xv) To notify the Graduate School of their intention to submit the thesis at least two months in advance of submission, on the appropriate form to which they must attach
  - the thesis abstract;
  - evidence that they have obtained at least 180 skills training credits which must include the statutory elements of the Skills Programme (see 4.2 above); and
  - evidence that they have cleared any laboratory area in which they have been working (see (xiv) above).
- (xvi) To ensure that the thesis is submitted before the registration expiry date, is the student's own work and is in the correct format, and that all appropriate acknowledgements have been made.

## 23. Code of Practice for the Directors of Postgraduate Research

The formal Graduate School structure comprises the Dean of Graduate Studies, the University Director of Postgraduate Research, the Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research, the Departmental Directors of Postgraduate Research. Each of these has specific duties and responsibilities in respect of the management of postgraduate research student matters.

### 23.1 Duties and Responsibilities of the University Director of Postgraduate Research

- (i) To manage and represent all postgraduate research in the University, with the assistance of the Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research and in accordance with the Ordinances, Regulations, Procedures and Policies of the University.
- (ii) To Chair the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee and be a member ex-officio of the Research Committee.
- (iii) To provide a formal report to each meeting of Research Committee on the work of the Graduate School.
- (iv) To oversee the registration, progression, monitoring and successful completion of all research students in the University.
- (v) To consider individual applications from students for changes to registration which have been referred and supported by the Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research, including applications for changes 'notwithstanding Ordinances and Regulations'.
- (vi) To work with all relevant parts of the University to improve the recruitment and retention of postgraduate research students.
- (vii) To be the final arbiter in cases where students have been recommended for termination of registration.
- (viii) To advise the University on its strategy in respect of research students and to implement the agreed strategy.
- (ix) To ensure that all supervisory staff and Directors of Postgraduate Research are aware of their duties and responsibilities and are appropriately trained and experienced.

- (x) To promote generally the postgraduate research culture of the University.
- (xi) To represent the University Graduate School on national bodies, such as UKGRAD and UKCGE.
- (xii) To ensure a smooth and effective handover of duties to their successor in post.

## 23.2 Duties and Responsibilities of the Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research

Under this Code, Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research have the following Duties and Responsibilities:

- (i) To co-ordinate all departmental and Faculty skills training in the relevant programmes, encouraging interdisciplinarity and cross-Faculty initiatives, and taking into account student needs and external developments.
- (ii) To undertake an annual review of all such research training taken by students in the Faculty (i.e. at departmental, Faculty and University levels), e.g. through obtaining student feedback.
- (iii) To be a member of the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee and to represent the Faculty's research students and staff on that Sub-Committee.
- (iv) To monitor all new programme proposals that contain research training, reporting to the appropriate Faculty Committee considering the programme, and also to the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee.
- (v) To promote postgraduate research opportunities to students and staff in the Faculty and outside the University, including bids for studentships to the Research Councils.
- (vi) To consider and advise the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee on ways in which the number of Research Council and/or AHRB postgraduate research studentships might be maximised.
- (vii) To ensure that all Faculty and departmental administrative procedures relating to research students are consistent with the Codes of Practice for Research Students and Supervisors and the Ordinances and Regulations governing the degrees of MPhil and PhD, and that good administrative practice is promoted generally within the Faculty.
- (viii) To oversee the annual monitoring exercise of research students in the Faculty
- (ix) To consider the merits of individual student applications for changes in registration (e.g. for suspensions or extensions), referring cases to the University Director of Postgraduate Research for approval where they are supported and informing students and supervisors if they are not supported.
- (x) To consider requests for exemptions from any part of the Skills Training Programme on the basis on prior learning, accreditation or experience.
- (xi) To review individual supervisory arrangements at the request of the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research
- (xii) To disseminate supervisory good practice, ensure that supervisory staff are appropriately trained and contribute to Supervisor Good Practice workshops as necessary.
- (xiii) To consider departmental recommendations for Examiners of research students on behalf of the Faculty, as required.
- (xiv) To use the funds provided by the Graduate School to support research students, for example by providing funds for conference attendance or other training or promotional purposes.
- (xv) To promote and facilitate a thriving research student community.
- (xvi) To make recommendations on appropriate business to the Faculty Research Committee and the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee.

- (xvii) To represent the Graduate School and the University at Postgraduate research-related external conferences and meetings as appropriate.
- (xviii) To ensure a smooth and effective handover of duties to their successor in post.

### 23.3 Duties and Responsibilities of the Departmental Directors of Postgraduate Research

Departmental Directors of Postgraduate Research have the following Duties and Responsibilities under this Code of Practice:

- (i) To ensure that the arrangements for supervision of a proposed new research student are appropriate, satisfy the University requirements and to request alternative nominations where this is not the case.
- (ii) To ensure that any promotional literature aimed at recruiting research students meets the requirements of the University's Code of Practice.
- (iii) To manage Skills Training components offered by the department, ensuring that they are properly advertised to students and staff and that a system for recording completed training components on the SPIDER system is in place and reliably operated.
- (iv) To arrange the Annual Monitoring of research students in the department, ensuring that there is an independent, interview-based review of each student.
- (v) To complete the relevant section of the student's Annual Progress Report, satisfying themselves that the reports of the student and supervisors are substantially in agreement and seeking further information where this is not the case.
- (vi) To be an independent person to whom the research student may turn in order to discuss any problems, for example with one of the supervisors.
- (vii) To arbitrate in the event that either student or one of the supervisors reports a problem in their working relationship.
- (viii) To manage generally the administration of research students in the department, dealing with cases of slow progress in a timely fashion and being proactive in identifying and addressing perceived problems, with a view to facilitating timely and successful completion.
- (ix) To report any problems or general issues which arise to the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research.
- (x) To represent the department's postgraduate business to the Faculty, for example in faculty meetings of Directors of Graduate Studies.
- (xi) To ensure that all supervisors in the department have attended a Good Practice workshop and to assist in the arrangement of such workshops as necessary.
- (xii) To ensure a smooth and effective handover of duties to their successor in post.

## 24. Code of Practice for Research Degree Examinations and Examiners

### 24.1 Appointment of Examiners

The formal responsibility for the appointment of examiners for MPhil, PhD and MD candidates rests with the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research. The following procedures should be adopted prior to the submission of examiners' names to the Faculty Director by the Head of Department:

- (i) The Primary Supervisor, on behalf of the supervisory team, should present the Head of Department concerned with a documentary synopsis of a candidate's thesis indicating clearly the field or fields of specialist study that are involved, to ensure the Head of Department (or his or her nominee) is aware of the expertise required of the examiners.
- (ii) Supervisors should also supply a list of proposed or potential internal and external examiners, with a clear indication of their specialised competence and how well this matches the detailed content of the candidate's thesis. (This is particularly important when the thesis embodies a range of work in disparate methodologies.)
- (iii) Supervisors should ensure that none of the proposed examiners have had a substantial direct involvement in the student's research project/thesis.
- (iv) Examiners should not be approached, even informally, until the Head of Department has seen the above documentation and has agreed to the nomination of the supervisor's suggested examiners.
- (v) Once the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research has ratified the Head of Department's choice of proposed examiners, the Graduate School will write to the examiners concerned outlining the conditions of appointment and their responsibilities.
- (vi) Candidates must not be consulted about, nor informed of, the choice of examiners until the formal appointment of examiners by the University has taken place.
- (vii) Where the candidate is a member of academic staff of the University, there must be two external examiners appointed in addition to an internal examiner.
- (viii) Former members of staff of the University may not act as an External Examiner until a period of five years has elapsed since leaving the employment of the University.

#### 24.2 Duties and Responsibilities of Internal Examiners

The internal examiner has the following responsibilities under this Code:

- (i) To arrange the date and location of the oral examination, in consultation with the external examiner(s) and the student and Primary Supervisor, ensuring that all parties are formally notified of the date, which must be no more than three months after submission of the thesis.
- (ii) To prepare an independent preliminary report on the thesis in advance of the examination, identifying any concerns and giving an initial recommendation. This must not be disclosed to or discussed with the student or the supervisors prior to the oral examination.
- (iii) To ensure that the external examiner has prepared an independent preliminary report in advance of the oral examination.
- (iv) To meet with the external examiner on the day of the examination before the candidate is seen, and to agree who will act as the Chairman for the examination and an outline of how the examination is to proceed.
- (v) To ensure that the oral examination is conducted in accordance with the Ordinances, Regulations and procedures of the University of Liverpool.
- (vi) To ensure that an agreed final report is produced and signed by all examiners, and to forward a copy of this to the Graduate School without delay.
- (vii) To ensure that any modifications or revisions required to a thesis are notified in detail to the candidate in writing, no later than one week after the oral examination.
- (viii) To ensure that informal feedback on the examination and the thesis is given to the candidate on the day of the examination.
- (ix) Where the examiners do not agree on a recommendation, to prepare an independent final report, and forward this to the Graduate School, and provide instructions to the external examiner(s) to do likewise.



- (x) Where minor modifications have been requested to the thesis, to ensure that all designated examiners have seen and approved the modifications and signed a form to this effect, which must be forwarded to the Graduate School.
- (xi) To report any significant problems which occur in the oral examination, or any general issues arising from it, to the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research.

### 24.3 Duties and Responsibilities of External Examiners

External Examiners, in accordance with the terms of their appointment, have the following responsibilities:

- (i) To read the thesis and prepare a preliminary report on it in advance of the oral examination, identifying any concerns and giving an initial recommendation. This must not be disclosed to or discussed with the student or the supervisors prior to the oral examination.
- (ii) To meet with the internal examiner and any other external examiners on the day of the examination before the candidate is seen, and to agree who will act as the Chairman for the examination and an outline of how the examination is to proceed.
- (iii) To conduct him/herself in the oral examination in a way which is fair and reasonable and gives the candidate every opportunity to explain and defend their work.
- (iv) To be rigorous in ensuring that the thesis and the candidate have been examined in accordance with the Ordinances and Regulations of the University of Liverpool.
- (v) To ensure that an agreed final report is signed by all examiners, and given to the internal examiner.
- (vi) To ensure that detailed feedback in respect of any modifications or revisions required to the thesis are made available to the internal examiner no later than one week after the examination.
- (vii) To agree with the other examiners who will be responsible for approving any modifications required to the thesis. Where this includes the external examiner, to ensure that the modified thesis is read and approved in a timely manner and the appropriate form signed and forwarded to the internal examiner or Graduate School as instructed.
- (viii) To give informal feedback to the candidate, with the other examiners, on the day of the examination.
- (ix) To ensure that any concerns about general issues are notified to the internal examiner. These may also be raised directly with the Graduate School.
- (x) Where the examiners do not agree on a recommendation, to prepare an independent final report, and forward this to the Graduate School.

### 25. Code of Practice for Off-Site Research Degrees

This Code of Practice relates to arrangements for research students spending the duration of their registration outside the University of Liverpool or one of its Accredited Institutions.

1. In accordance with the Ordinances and Regulations governing the degrees of MPhil and PhD, all requests for a research student to spend the duration of his/her registration outside the University are subject to approval, initially at Faculty level and then by the University Director of Postgraduate Research. This approval process must be undertaken before the student is formally accepted or registered.
2. It is expected that the student will be based at an institution that has the facilities to support a candidate for a University of Liverpool MPhil or PhD, including a research-active environment and access to information technologies (most notably for remote access of library resources and electronic mail). Students must have a designated supervisor at the University of Liverpool who meets the usual requirements to be a University Supervisor, and a local supervisor at the institution at which they will be based. Typical institutions are likely to be Universities with a limited range

of research degree programmes, prestigious research institutes, private companies and government agencies.

3. Academic Departments wishing to accept a student on this basis should submit the following documentation to the Graduate School:
  - (i) The student's application for postgraduate study.
  - (ii) A CV of the proposed external supervisor. He/she is expected to hold a permanent employment contract and be research-active, e.g. by having a publications record. The CV should also provide details of any students previously supervised to successful completion of higher degrees.
  - (iii) A proposed plan of supervisory sessions with the Liverpool supervisor, to provide at least three sessions per year, one of which must be held face-to-face. At least one session must be held every four months. Details of how the visits will be funded are required. Details of how a Personal Development Record will be maintained and how the Graduate School Skills Programme will be completed are also required.

If the request is approved, the documentation will be forwarded to the University Director of Postgraduate Research for consideration on behalf of the University's Research Committee. The Graduate School Administrator, on behalf of the Director, will inform the Faculty Office whether consent has been given to register the student. If approved, the Faculty Office will send the formal offer letter to the student in the usual manner.

4. All students accepted under these arrangements are subject to the University of Liverpool's Ordinances and Regulations governing the degrees of MPhil and PhD, including the requirement to undertake the annual progress monitoring procedure and attend the University's Skills Training Programme. Requests for exemption from parts of the Programme will be considered on the grounds of prior experience or accreditation in the normal way.
5. The content and form of the thesis and procedures relating to the examination of the thesis will be the same as for all other MPhil and PhD examinations. The oral examination will normally be conducted at the University of Liverpool. However, the University Director of Postgraduate Research will consider requests for the oral examination to be held via video-conferencing on an exceptional basis.
6. Students accepted under these terms will be required to register as students of the University of Liverpool for each year of the programme and make arrangements for the payment of the appropriate tuition fees.

## 26. **Framework for Research Master's Programmes**

The essential features of this framework are:

- (i) the programme should be a research programme containing at least 180 credits.
- (ii) there should be a research project(s) comprising of a minimum of 120 credits which should be supervised by members of staff selected on the basis of their research expertise. The number of students that may be supervised by one member of staff must take into account the significant staff effort that is involved in supervision;
- (iii) all assessed work should be examined by at least two examiners;
- (iv) each candidate should undergo an oral examination of no more than 30 minutes with an external examiner on their research project(s) to validate the standard of grading of the programme;
- (v) all provision should be modularised with each module being given a credit value and an associated level;

- (vi) the credit values should be assigned on the basis that 10 hours of student commitment (divided into variable mixes of contact and private study hours) should be allocated 1 credit point;
- (vii) normally all credit in all programmes should be at Masters level, however it is permissible for a programme to contain up to 30 credits at level 3;
- (viii) the number of credit points attached to the research project(s) must be at least 120 credits and the number of credit points attached to research and transferable skills modules must be at least 15 credits;
- (ix) each programme of study can contain a number of subject-specific research related modules which should each have a value of 5 or 7.5 or 10 or 15 or 20 or 30 credit points, up to a maximum of 45 credits in total;
- (x) all provision will have clearly defined assessments for each module with a pass mark of 50%.

### Guidelines

The following forms the basis for consideration of new proposals at Graduate School and University level. Exemptions from these guidelines must be presented to and approved by the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee.

- (i) It is expected that all programmes will be semesterised;
- (ii) Programmes may be designed to begin at the start of any semester and may have intakes annually, at the beginning of every semester or less frequently than annually;
- (iii) Programmes which include modules from more than one department should ensure that module sizes are compatible so that student study patterns are realistically implementable;
- (iv) Programmes should be designed to ensure an even spread of workload throughout the programme;
- (v) Programmes should not have exit points at postgraduate certificate or postgraduate diploma levels;
- (vi) Programme provision should be compatible with the following definitions:

#### **Master of Research**

A vocational or non-vocational programme involving:

- a) a research element of at least 120 credits;
- b) a range of assessed modules that must contain advanced research related knowledge and advanced research skills;

that reflects the level of further intellectual development appropriate to the equivalent of one year's advanced study beyond Honours degree level and is an appropriate foundation for research degree registration.

- (vii) all provision should have requirements for qualifying for the award of a Master's of Research:
  - the achievement of a mark of 50% or more in every module and in any dissertation;
  - provision, where the average of the total marks in all modules is 50% or above, for a mark of 40-49% to be deemed compensatable in subject-specific modules totalling up to 15 credits;

- a mark of Distinction should be awarded as detailed below, but only where the requirements were achieved at the first attempt (a Distinction cannot be awarded if a candidate has failed any credit during the period of study at the University):
- Master's of Research: a Distinction should be awarded for candidates who have achieved:
  - marks of at least 70% in their research project(s); and
  - an overall average score of at least 70% across all modules that are assessed by formal examination; and
  - an overall module mark of at least 70% in any modules that are continuously assessed.

Re-sits should take place within the registration period and module marks for the taught period of study should be considered at the end of Semester Two or Three at the Module Review Boards; mitigating circumstances should also be considered at this point. External Examiners would not be expected to attend the Mitigating Circumstances Committee but would be welcome to attend if they were available. Students will normally be granted at least one opportunity to retrieve a failure in any module or in a dissertation either by re-examination or re-submission. Marks achieved in re-sits shall be recorded as the actual mark achieved but shall be flagged in the transcript to indicate that they were achieved at second attempt.

## 27. Framework for Professional Doctorate Programmes

The essential features of this framework are:

- i) That professional doctorates do not fit within the postgraduate taught framework as they are 3 year programmes at doctorate level;
- ii) That the proposed basis of the framework for professional doctorates within the University was approved by ASSC in December 2007;
- iii) The research element of the professional doctorate programme should at least 50% of the total content.
- iv) The research element of the programme should meet the definition of research (the Frascati definition of research).
- v) The research element (thesis) should be supervised by members of staff selected on the basis of their research expertise. To meet the University's requirements for supervision of research programmes, there should be at least two supervisors. The supervisors should not be the programme director for all students as it would not be possible to support a claim that significant staff effort is involved in supervision if the programme director supervises all students.
- vi) There shall be a minimum of two Examiners to assess an application for a Professional Doctorate. There shall always be an Internal Examiner and an External Examiner. A candidate's supervisors shall normally be consulted before the Examiners are appointed. A supervisor may not be appointed as an Internal Examiner. In the case of a member of academic staff, a second External Examiner shall be appointed.
- vii) All professional doctorate programmes should be modularised, with each module being given a credit value and associated level.
- viii) Credit values should be assigned on the basis that 10 hours of student commitment (divided into variable mixes of contact and private study hours) should be allocated 1 credit point.
- ix) All professional doctorate programmes should consist of 540 credits delivered over three years full-time (or part-time equivalent); there should be 180 credits in each year of study and workloads

should be divided equally between semesters and years of study. Any proposal for a programme to be designed with an imbalance in the amount of credit studied in each year will require specific permission from the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee.

- x) The research element of professional doctorate programmes should be a minimum of 270 credits, in addition there should be a minimum of 60 credits of research and professional skills training; remaining credit may be subject specific modules.
- xi) It is an expectation of all doctoral degrees that they are a 3-year commitment towards a doctoral qualification and should only be undertaken with this as the understood end point. However, in line with the MPhil exit point for PhD degrees, professional doctorate programmes may have an exit point at Master's level for students who do not make progress adequate for continuation to the doctorate. The Masters award should have the same title as the Professional Doctorate e.g. MForensicPsychology.
- xii) The award of a Masters qualification will require attainment of 180 credits at M level of which a minimum of 120 should be awarded for research.
- xiii) All taught modules within a professional doctorate programme shall have a pass mark of 50%.
- xiv) The taught element of professional doctorate programmes shall normally be completed by the end of Year 2 of the programme.
- xv) All professional doctorate programmes will permit entry with credit attributed to previous certificated study up to a total of one third of the credits required to be awarded a professional doctorate or a master's award.

## Guidelines

The following form the basis for consideration of new proposals at Faculty and University level. Exemptions from these guidelines must be presented to and approved by the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee.

- i) It is expected that all professional doctorate programmes will be semesterised.
- ii) That there should be encouragement for programmes to use the University generic skills training modules; however this would be an option and not a requirement.
- iii) Professional doctorate programmes that include modules from more than one department should ensure that module sizes are compatible so that student study patterns are realistically implementable.
- iv) All professional doctorate programmes should be compatible with the following definitions:

### Professional Doctorate

A programme that requires the creation and interpretation of new knowledge, through original research or other advanced scholarship. There should be systematic acquisition and understanding of a substantial body of knowledge which is at the forefront of academic discipline or area of professional practice and the requirement to demonstrate detailed understanding of applicable techniques for research and advanced academic enquiry.

### Master's

A programme involving both a substantial piece of independent work and a range of assessed modules, whose combined challenge reflects the level of further intellectual development

appropriate to the equivalent of one year's advanced study beyond Honours degree level and is an appropriate foundation for research degree registration.

- v) All professional doctorate programmes must comply with the following framework for awards:

#### Professional Doctorate

At least 540 credits of which a minimum of 360 credits must be at D level, all other credits being at M level.

A research element that comprises a minimum of 270 credits plus 60 credits of research and professional skills training.

#### Master's (if awarded)

At least 180 credits at M level.

A research element that comprises at least 120 credits.

- vi) All professional doctorate programmes should have requirements for qualifying for the award of a Professional Doctorate or Master's (if awarded) which include:
- vii) The achievement of a mark of 50% or more in every taught module.
- viii) Provision for compensation such that in each year of study, a mark of 40-49% is deemed compensatable in subject specific modules totalling up to 15 credits.
- ix) Provision for students who fail taught assessments to be allowed to re-sit the failed assessment on one occasion only. The re-sit should take place before the next year of study commences. Resubmission of a thesis within one year upon the recommendation of the examiners.
- x) Successful completion of the programme within seven years of the date of initial registration.

#### Examination procedures

Each professional doctorate programme should appoint an external examiner to verify and approve the taught elements of the course. External examiners for the research component and final thesis viva voce should be appointed in the same way as for PhD programmes, i.e. each student would be examined for the research element presented as a written thesis by an external and internal examiner appointed for that specific purpose.

#### Academic Standards

A sub-group of the Postgraduate Research Sub-Committee (PGRSC) has been established, called the Postgraduate Research Standards Group (PGRSG), to approve and monitor Professional Doctorate Programmes. Academic Committee will be responsible for approval of outline cases for new programmes and the PGRSG will consider and approve full cases. The decision will be ratified by the PGRSC that reports to the University Research Committee and finally to the University Academic Committee

## SECTION IV: Ordinances and Regulations

In the following Ordinances and Regulations some arrangements are identified as being ‘exceptional’. In such cases, approval for these arrangements must be obtained from the University Director of Postgraduate Research prior to initial registration for the degree.

Within the several sets of regulations the word “thesis” is used generally to represent the total submitted work to be examined for the degree.

### 28. Ordinance and Regulations for the Degree of Master of Philosophy

#### Ordinance

The University of Liverpool, for the encouragement of graduate research study, has established a Degree of Master of Philosophy (MPhil) in the Faculties of Arts, Science, Medicine, Engineering, Veterinary Science and Social and Environmental Studies.

The Degree of Master of Philosophy may be conferred upon:

A graduate of this or any other approved University or Institution, or a candidate who holds a qualification deemed by the Senate to be equivalent to an Honours Degree of this University who has submitted one of the following:

a thesis embodying the results of his/her individual research. The thesis may contain published papers, in which case these must be integrated into the thesis in a coherent and structured manner; or

a published book or books describing a coherent line of research; or

a substantial collection of original creative material developed specifically in pursuit of the degree, together with a written thesis which contextualises that work within an academic framework;

which is adjudged to make a contribution to learning; which is coherently structured and clearly presented; and which shows evidence of systematic study and of ability to relate the results of such study to the general body of knowledge in the subject.

Candidates for the degree will comply with the conditions contained within one of the following clauses:-

- 1 s/he has pursued full-time research in the University or in an Affiliated Institution approved by the Council for the purposes of this clause, for not less than one calendar year.
- 2 s/he is a member of the full-time academic staff of this University, or a member, recognised by the Council as a teacher of the University, of the full-time staff of an Affiliated Institution which has been approved by the Council for the purposes of this clause, who has pursued part-time research for a minimum of two years. The evidence on which the application is based shall be presented no later than two years after the applicant has left the service of the University or Affiliated Institution.
- 3 s/he has pursued part-time research for not less than two years; the time spent studying during this period being equivalent to not less than one years full-time study;
- 4 s/he holds a temporary post as a Research Fellow, Research Assistant, Senior Research Assistant, or Research Associate in a Department of the University or an Affiliated Institution approved by the Council for the purposes of this clause, who has, whilst holding their appointment, pursued research for not less than one year and six months; at least twelve months of which must be spent in the University or Affiliated Institution;

For candidates registered under each of the above Clauses the following further conditions apply:-

- a) the research must be carried out under the supervision of at least two members of the academic staff of the University or Affiliated Institution appointed by the appropriate Head of Department;
- b) the Senate may exceptionally permit a part or all of the research to be pursued outside the University under approved conditions;
- c) before the commencement of the programme, each candidate must have submitted evidence satisfactory to the University of adequate training and ability to pursue the proposed programme of research;
- d) the final submission for the degree shall not include work for which a degree or other qualification has already been awarded, except that for the sake of completeness where some previous work has been substantially further developed. In that case, all such work shall be clearly identified;
- e) only papers or book(s) written during the period of registration for the degree will be admissible and the papers or book(s) submitted should have a common theme with an identifiable link.
- f) applications for the degree based on the submission of a collection of original creative material together with a written thesis shall be accepted, on an exceptional basis, when the subject area of the submitted work is within Fine Art and the Performing Arts.

## Regulations

Within these regulations the word “thesis” is used generally to represent the total submitted work to be examined for the degree.

*All candidates should refer to Regulations 6-20.*

### For candidates under Clause 1 of the Ordinance (i.e. full-time candidates)

- 1 A candidate who proposes to pursue their research study outside the University will need:
  1. an approved local co-supervisor who should normally hold a permanent post and have a suitable research record;
  2. to undertake successfully the Research Training Programme or obtain exemption on the grounds of suitable prior experience of accreditation.

Each case must be submitted for approval by the University Director of Postgraduate Research on behalf of the Senate prior to the candidate's acceptance.

- 2 Every candidate is required during his/her course of study to devote the whole of his/her time to his/her research. S/he may, however, be allowed to undertake other work for not more than fifteen hours a week (or the equivalent of fifteen hours per week when averaged across a given academic session), unless otherwise restricted by the terms and conditions of sponsorship agreements, subject to the discretion of the Head of the Department. Candidates seeking to be allowed to undertake other work must apply in writing to the Director of Postgraduate Research, stating fully the nature and extent of the proposed work, save that Student Teaching Assistants appointed by the Senate do not require permission in respect of such work undertaken in the University.



- 3 Upon application to the University Director of Postgraduate Research, a student registered under this clause may exceptionally be permitted to transfer his/her registration from full-time to part-time study. If a student is permitted to transfer his/her registration from full-time to part-time after one year, the thesis may not normally be presented for examination before the end of the second year of registration or later than the fifth year of registration. Transfers to part-time registration requested after more than one year of full-time registration will not be permitted.
- 4 A thesis will normally be submitted for examination within two years of first registration for the degree and by not later than the end of the fourth year of registration. No extension of the period of registration will be granted, except with the special permission of the Senate, and then normally only for reasons of ill-health or circumstances outside the control of the candidate. Notice of intention to submit a thesis shall be given on the prescribed form to the University or Affiliated Institution not less than two months before the date of submission.

For candidates under Clauses 2, 3 and 4 of the Ordinance (i.e. part-time candidates)

- 5 A thesis must be submitted for examination within six years of first registration for the degree. No extension of the period of registration will be granted, except with the special permission of the Senate and then normally only for reasons of ill-health or circumstances outside the control of the candidate. Notice of intention to submit a thesis shall be given on the prescribed form to the University or Affiliated Institution not less than two months before the date of submission.

For all candidates

- 6 A candidate who has been accepted for a programme for the degree of M.Phil. may be permitted, by the Director of Postgraduate Research to transfer to the programme for the degree of Ph.D. so far as Ordinances and Regulations permit, provided that
- (a) such transfer takes place after the first year of registration for a full-time candidate or the second year of registration for a part-time candidate, and before giving notice of intention to submit a thesis;
  - (b) there is clear evidence of adequate training and ability to pursue doctoral study.
- 7 Every candidate shall register as a student of the University at the beginning of his/her programme, and again at the beginning of each subsequent year of the programme, subject to the submission of a satisfactory report on the progress of their study.
- 8 A student who is registered for the degree of MPhil shall not be registered for any other degree, diploma or certificate.
- 9 There shall be a minimum of two Examiners to assess an application for the degree of MPhil. There shall always be an Internal Examiner and an External Examiner. A candidate's supervisors shall normally be consulted before the Examiners are appointed. A supervisor may not be appointed as an Internal Examiner. In the case of Clause 2 candidates, a second External Examiner shall be appointed.
- 10 Every candidate shall be required to complete the Research Training Programme to the satisfaction of the University Director of Postgraduate Research.
- 11 A candidate shall state generally in the preface and specifically in the body of the thesis, the sources from which his/her information is derived and the extent to which s/he has availed himself/herself of the work of others.
- 12 Where submission is by written thesis alone, the thesis should be as concise as possible and in no circumstances may a thesis be submitted should the number of words exceed 60,000, including footnotes and appendices without written permission being obtained from a candidate's supervisors and the Head of

Department concerned. Where the written thesis accompanies the submission of a collection of original creative material, the thesis should not exceed 25,000 words.

- 13 The written thesis, whether it is the whole submission or part of a submission, must be written in English. In the case of candidates working in the discipline of Modern Languages, the University may, exceptionally, allow a thesis to be submitted in a language other than English provided that such approval is sought and granted at the time of initial registration.
- 14 It will normally be expected that the candidate is the primary author of the majority of the papers or the book(s) submitted. Where joint authorship does occur, a statement of the contribution made by the applicant shall be provided, together with the status of the other authors.
- 15 Two copies of each submission shall be presented to the University or to the Affiliated Institution for examination and shall be accompanied by a notification of submission on the prescribed form, duly completed by the candidate.

Printed theses should be presented for examination in a secure temporary binding (by which is meant the thesis should be presented in such a way that the pages cannot be readily removed; therefore the use of ring binders is not permitted), bearing the title of the work on the front cover, together with the candidate's surname, initials, degree and the year. After the thesis has been approved by the Examiners a copy must be submitted to the University library in electronic form and made available on the University Institutional Repository. The thesis shall be submitted in the electronic form prescribed by the Institutional Repository policy of the University (see <https://eprints.liv.ac.uk/policies/e-these.html>) and may be copied into a new medium or format for the purpose of future preservation and accessibility. The thesis shall be accompanied by a separate abstract indicating the aims of the investigations and the results achieved. Each abstract must not be longer than can be accomplished by single spaced typing on one side of an A4 sheet, i.e. about 450 words maximum and must show the author and title of the thesis in the form of a heading.

- 16 When exceptionally a book or books are submitted in place of a thesis, each copy of the application must contain a printed summary stating the aims of the investigation, the results achieved and the main contribution to learning of the work submitted in the application; clear photocopies are acceptable.
- 17 Where a collection of original creative material is also submitted for examination, the archival record should include photographic, video, cd-rom or dvd evidence, which encompasses the material submitted and any artefacts or documentation integral to the creation of the work. A short inventory with brief descriptions should also be included.
- 18 An oral examination of the candidate shall be held, when the Examiners shall examine the candidate on the subject of the thesis, and on matters relevant thereto. Supervisors may not be present at the oral examination but should be readily available to the Examiners for consultation before, during and after the oral examination.
- 19 Each Examiner shall prepare an independent written report before the oral examination. After the oral examination, a joint report should be prepared, including, when appropriate, an agreed recommendation. If the Examiners are unable to agree on a recommendation, an additional External Examiner may be appointed, who shall be required to act independently of the other Examiners.
- 20 The Examiners may recommend:
  - (i) that the degree of MPhil be conferred
  - (ii) that the degree of MPhil be conferred subject to the candidate making minor modifications to the thesis, which do not alter the substance of the thesis in any significant or fundamental manner, to the satisfaction of one or more of the Examiners, as may be agreed between them.
  - (iii) that the candidate be permitted to make a subsequent application for the degree of MPhil on one occasion only, provided that the application is made not more than one calendar year from the date

of the oral examination. A thesis may only be re-presented as the result of a recommendation made in accordance with this provision, and shall be revised having due regard to the Examiners' observations. A second oral examination shall normally be held, but this may be waived at the discretion of the Examiners;

- (iv) that the candidate be deemed not to have attained the standard required for the degree of MPhil and that no further opportunity be allowed for examination.

## 29. Ordinance and Regulations for the Degree of Doctor in Philosophy

### Ordinance

The University of Liverpool, for the encouragement of graduate research study, has established a Doctorate in Philosophy (PhD) in the Faculties of Arts, Science, Medicine, Engineering, Veterinary Science and Social and Environmental Studies.

The Degree of Doctor in Philosophy may be conferred upon:

A graduate of this or any other approved University or Institution, or a candidate who holds a qualification deemed by the Senate to be equivalent to an Honours Degree of this University who has submitted one of the following:

- a thesis embodying the results of his/her individual research. The thesis may contain published papers, in which case these must be integrated into the thesis in a coherent and structured manner; or
- a published book or books describing a coherent line of research; or
- a substantial collection of original creative material developed specifically in pursuit of the degree, together with a written thesis which contextualises that work within an academic framework;
- which is adjudged to make an original contribution to learning; which is coherently structured and clearly presented; and which shows evidence of systematic study and of ability to relate the results of such study to the general body of knowledge in the subject.

Candidates for the degree will comply with the conditions contained within one of the following clauses:-

- 1 s/he has pursued full-time research in the University or in an Affiliated Institution approved by the Council for the purposes of this clause, for not less than two calendar years;
- 2 s/he is a member of the full-time academic staff of this University, or a member, recognised by the Council as a teacher of the University, or the full-time staff of an Affiliated Institution which has been approved by the Council for the purposes of this clause, who has pursued part-time research for a minimum of four years. The evidence on which the submission is made shall be presented no later than two years after the candidate has left the employment of the University or Affiliated Institution.
- 3 s/he has pursued part-time research for not less than four years; the time spent studying during this period being equivalent to not less than two years full-time study;
- 4 s/he holds a temporary post as a Research Fellow, Research Assistant, Senior Research Assistant, or Research Associate in a Department of the University or an Affiliated Institution approved by the Council for the purposes of this clause, who has, whilst holding their appointment, pursued research for not less than two years and nine months; at least twelve months of which must be spent in the University or Affiliated Institution.

For candidates registered under each of the above Clauses the following further conditions apply:-

- a) the research must be carried out under the supervision of at least two members of the academic staff of the University or Affiliated Institution appointed by the appropriate Head of Department;
- b) the Senate may exceptionally permit a part or all of the research to be pursued outside the University under approved conditions;
- c) before the commencement of the programme, each candidate must have submitted evidence satisfactory to the University of adequate training and ability to pursue the proposed programme of research;

- d) the final submission for the degree shall not include work for which a degree or other qualification has already been awarded, except that for the sake of completeness where some previous work has been substantially further developed. In that case, all such work shall be clearly identified;
- e) only papers or book(s) written during the period of registration for the degree will be admissible and the papers or book(s) submitted should have a common theme with an identifiable link;
- f) applications for the degree based on the submission of a collection of original creative material together with a written thesis shall be accepted, on an exceptional basis, when the subject area of the submitted work is within Fine Art and the Performing Arts.

## Regulations

*All candidates should refer to Regulations 6-20*

### For candidates under Clause 1 of the Ordinance (i.e. full-time candidates)

- 1 A candidate who proposes to pursue their research study outside the University will need:
  1. an approved local co-supervisor who should normally hold a permanent post and have a suitable research record;
  2. to undertake successfully the Research Training Programme or obtain exemption on the grounds of suitable prior experience of accreditation.

Each case must be submitted for approval by the University Director of Postgraduate Research on behalf of the Senate prior to the candidate's acceptance.

- 2 Every candidate is required during his/her course of study to devote the whole of his/her time to his/her research. S/he may, however, be allowed to undertake other work for not more than fifteen hours a week (or the equivalent of fifteen hours per week when averaged across a given academic session), unless otherwise restricted by the terms and conditions of sponsorship agreements, subject to the discretion of the Head of the Department. Candidates seeking to be allowed to undertake other work must apply in writing to the Director of Postgraduate Research, stating fully the nature and extent of the proposed work, save that Student Teaching Assistants appointed by the Senate do not require permission in respect of such work undertaken in the University.
- 3 Upon application to the University Director of Postgraduate Research, a student registered under this clause may exceptionally be permitted to transfer his/her registration from full-time to part-time study. If a student is permitted to transfer his/her registration from full-time to part-time after one year, the thesis may not normally be presented for examination before the end of the fourth year of registration or later than the sixth year of registration. If a student is permitted to transfer his/her registration from full-time to part-time after two years, the thesis may not normally be presented before the end of the fourth year of registration or later than the fifth year of registration. Transfers to part-time registration requested after more than two years of full-time registration will not be permitted.
- 4 A thesis will normally be submitted for examination within three years of first registration for the degree and by not later than the end of the fourth year of registration. No extension of the period of registration will be granted, except with the special permission of the Senate, and then normally only for reasons of ill-health or circumstances outside the control of the candidate. Notice of intention to submit a thesis shall be given on the prescribed form to the University or Affiliated Institution not less than two months before the date of submission.

### For candidates under Clauses 2, 3 and 4 of the Ordinance (i.e. part-time candidates)

- 5 A thesis must be submitted for examination within seven years of first registration for the degree. No extension of the period of registration will be granted, except with the special permission of the Senate, and then normally only for reasons of ill-health or circumstances outside the control of the candidate.

Notice of intention to submit a thesis shall be given on the prescribed form to the University or Affiliated Institution not less than two months before the date of submission.

### For all Candidates

- 6 A candidate who has been accepted for a programme for the degree of Ph.D. may be permitted by the Director of Postgraduate Research to transfer to the programme for the Master of Philosophy degree provided that such transfer takes place before the thesis is submitted.
- 7 Every candidate shall register as a student of the University at the beginning of his/her programme, and again at the beginning of each subsequent year of the programme, subject to the submission of a satisfactory report on the progress of their study.
- 8 A student who is registered for the degree of PhD shall not be registered for any other degree, diploma or certificate.
- 9 There shall be a minimum of two Examiners to assess an application for the degree of Ph.D. There shall always be an Internal Examiner and an External Examiner. A candidate's supervisors shall normally be consulted before the Examiners are appointed. A supervisor may not be appointed as an Internal Examiner. In the case of Clause 2 candidates, a second External Examiner shall be appointed.
- 10 Every candidate shall be required to complete the Research Training Programme to the satisfaction of the University Director of Postgraduate Research.
- 11 A candidate shall state generally in the preface and specifically in the body of the thesis, the sources from which his/her information is derived and the extent to which s/he has availed himself/herself of the work of others.
- 12 Where submission is by written thesis alone, the thesis should be as concise as possible and in no circumstances may a thesis be submitted should the number of words exceed 100,000, including footnotes and appendices without written permission being obtained from a candidate's supervisors and the Head of Department concerned. Where the written thesis accompanies the submission of a collection of original creative material, the thesis should not exceed 50,000 words.
- 13 The written thesis, whether it is the whole submission or part of a submission, must be written in English. In the case of candidates working in the discipline of Modern Languages, the University may, exceptionally, allow a thesis to be submitted in a language other than English provided that such approval is sought and granted at the time of initial registration.
- 14 It will normally be expected that the candidate is the primary author of the majority of the papers or the book(s) submitted. Where joint authorship does occur, a statement of the contribution made by the applicant shall be provided, together with the status of the other authors.
- 15 Two copies of each submission shall be presented to the University or to the Affiliated Institution for examination and shall be accompanied by a notification of submission on the prescribed form, duly completed by the candidate.

Printed theses should be presented for examination in a secure temporary binding (by which is meant the thesis should be presented in such a way that the pages cannot be readily removed; therefore the use of ring binders is not permitted), bearing the title of the work on the front cover, together with the candidate's surname, initials, degree and the year. After the thesis has been approved by the Examiners a copy must be submitted to the University library in electronic form and made available on the University Institutional Repository. The thesis shall be submitted in the electronic form prescribed by the Institutional Repository policy of the University (see <https://eprints.liv.ac.uk/policies/e-theses.html>) and may be copied into a new medium or format for the purpose of future preservation and accessibility. The thesis shall be accompanied by a separate abstract indicating the aims of the investigations and the results achieved. Each abstract must

not be longer than can be accomplished by single spaced typing on one side of an A4 sheet, i.e. about 450 words maximum and must show the author and title of the thesis in the form of a heading.

- 16 When, exceptionally, a book or books are submitted in place of a thesis, each copy of the application must contain a printed summary stating the aims of the investigation, the results achieved and the main contribution to learning of the work submitted in the application; clear photocopies are acceptable.
- 17 Where a collection of original creative material is also submitted for examination, the archival record should include photographic, video, cd-rom or dvd evidence, which encompasses the material submitted and any artefacts or documentation integral to the creation of the work. A short inventory with brief descriptions should also be included.
- 18 An oral examination of the candidate shall be held, when the Examiners shall examine the candidate on the subject of the thesis and on matters relevant thereto. Supervisors may not be present at the oral examination but should be readily available to the Examiners for consultation before, during and after the oral examination.
- 19 Each Examiner shall prepare an independent written report before the oral examination. After the oral examination, a joint report should be prepared, including, when appropriate, an agreed recommendation. If the Examiners are unable to agree on a recommendation, an additional External Examiner may be appointed, who shall be required to act independently of the other Examiners.
- 20 The Examiners may recommend:
  - (i) that the degree of PhD be conferred.
  - (ii) that the degree of PhD be conferred subject to the candidate making minor modifications to the thesis, which do not alter the substance of the thesis in any significant or fundamental manner, to the satisfaction of one or more of the Examiners, as may be agreed between them.
  - (iii) that the candidate be permitted to make a subsequent application for the degree of PhD on one occasion only, provided that the application is made not more than one calendar year from the date of the oral examination. A thesis may only be re-presented as the result of a recommendation made in accordance with this provision, and shall be revised having due regard to the Examiners' observations. A second oral examination shall normally be held, but this may be waived at the discretion of the Examiners;
  - (iv) that the degree of Master of Philosophy be conferred upon the candidate, subject to, if required, minor modifications being made to the thesis to the satisfaction of one or more of the examiners, as may be agreed between them;
  - (v) that the candidate be permitted to make a subsequent application for the degree of MPhil on one occasion only, provided that the application is made not more than one calendar year from the date of the oral examination. A thesis may only be re-presented as the result of a recommendation made in accordance with this provision, and shall be revised having due regard to the Examiners' observations. A second oral examination shall normally be held, but this may be waived at the discretion of the Examiners;
  - (vi) that the candidate be deemed not to have attained the standard required for the degree of PhD or MPhil and that no further opportunity be allowed for examination.

### 30. Ordinance and Regulations for the Degree of Doctor of Medicine

#### Ordinance

- 1 The Degree of Doctor of Medicine (MD) may be conferred, after report from the Board of the Faculty of Medicine, upon graduates in Medicine of this or an approved University, who hold a medical qualification registrable in the United Kingdom, not less than two years after the date of admission to their medical degree.
- 2 A candidate shall be required to present a thesis embodying the results of his/her individual research. The thesis may contain published papers, in which case these must be integrated into the thesis in a coherent and structured manner. Applications for the degree based on the submission of a book or books shall be accepted on an exceptional basis only. Only papers or book(s) written during the period of registration for the degree will be permissible and the papers or book(s) submitted should have a common theme with an identified link.
- 3 A thesis shall embody a critical survey of the literature and the results of personal observations or original research either in some branch of medicine or in some science directly related to medicine. The candidate is required to present a thesis, which is adjudged to make a contribution to learning, and which shows evidence of systematic study and of ability to relate the results of such study to the general body of knowledge in the subject.
- 4 The research must be carried out under the supervision of at least two members of the academic staff of the University appointed by the appropriate Head of Department.
- 5 The Faculty may exceptionally permit a part or all of the research to be pursued outside the University under approved conditions.
- 6 Before the commencement of the programme, each candidate must have submitted evidence satisfactory to the Faculty and the University of adequate training and ability to pursue the proposed programme of research.
- 7 The final submission for the degree shall not include work for which a degree or other qualification has already been awarded, except that for the sake of completeness where some previous work has been substantially further developed. In that case, all such work shall be clearly identified.

#### Regulations

- 1 A candidate who proposes to pursue their research study outside the University must have an additional local supervisor approved by the appropriate University Head of Department.
- 2 Every candidate shall be required to complete the Research Training Programme to the satisfaction of the University Director of Postgraduate Research.
- 3 Every candidate shall register as a part-time student of the University at the beginning of his/her programme, and again at the beginning of each subsequent year of the programme, subject to the submission of a satisfactory report on the progress of their study.
- 4 Candidates shall pursue part-time research for not less than two years, from the date of first registration, and must submit their thesis for examination not later than six years from the date of first registration. No extension of the period of registration will be granted, except with the special permission of the Senate, and then normally only for reasons of ill-health or circumstances outside the control of the candidate. Notice of intention to submit a thesis shall be given on the prescribed form to the University not less than two months before the date of submission.

- 5 A candidate shall state generally in the preface and specifically in the body of the thesis, the sources from which his/her information is derived and the extent to which s/he has availed himself/herself of the work of others.
- 6 Where submission is by written thesis alone, the thesis should be as concise as possible and in no circumstances may a thesis be submitted should the number of words exceed 100,000, including footnotes and appendices without written permission being obtained from a candidate's supervisors and the Head of Department concerned.
- 7 It will normally be expected that the candidate is the primary author of the majority of the books or papers submitted. Where joint authorship does occur, a statement of the contribution made by the applicant shall be provided, together with the status of the other authors.
- 8 Two copies of each submission shall be presented to the University for examination and shall be accompanied by a notification of submission on the prescribed form, duly completed by the candidate. Printed theses should be presented for examination in a secure temporary binding (by which is meant the thesis should be presented in such a way that the pages cannot be readily removed; therefore the use of ring binders is not permitted), bearing the title of the work on the front cover, together with the candidate's surname, initials, degree and the year. After the thesis has been approved by the Examiners a copy must be submitted to the University library in electronic form and made available on the University Institutional Repository. The thesis shall be submitted in the electronic form prescribed by the Institutional Repository policy of the University (see <https://eprints.liv.ac.uk/policies/e-these.html>) and may be copied into a new medium or format for the purpose of future preservation and accessibility. The thesis shall be accompanied by a separate abstract indicating the aims of the investigations and the results achieved. Each abstract must not be longer than can be accomplished by single spaced typing on one side of an A4 sheet, i.e. about 450 words maximum and must show the author and title of the thesis in the form of a heading.
- 9 There shall be a minimum of two Examiners, at least one of whom shall be an External Examiner. Where the candidate is a member of the full-time academic staff there shall be two External Examiners and an Internal Examiner. The candidate's supervisor shall not be eligible for appointment as an Examiner.
- 10 Each Examiner shall prepare an independent written report before the oral examination. After the oral examination, a joint report should be prepared by the Examiners including, when appropriate, an agreed recommendation. If the Examiners are unable to agree on a recommendation, an additional External Examiner may be appointed, who shall be required to act independently of the other examiners.
- 11 An oral examination of the candidate shall be held, when the Examiners shall examine the candidate on the subject of the thesis, and on matters relevant thereto. A candidate's supervisor may not be present at the oral examination but should be readily available to the Examiners for consultation before during and after the oral examination.
- 12 The Examiners may recommend:
- (i) that the degree of MD be conferred.
  - (ii) that the degree of MD be conferred subject to the candidate making minor modifications to the thesis, which do not alter the substance of the thesis in any significant or fundamental manner, to the satisfaction of one or more of the Examiners, as may be agreed between them.
  - (iii) that the candidate be permitted to make a subsequent application for the degree of MD on one further occasion only, provided that the application is made not more than one calendar year from the date of the oral examination. A thesis may only be re-presented as the result of a recommendation made in accordance with this provision, and shall be revised having due regard to the Examiners' observations. A second oral examination shall normally be held, but this may be waived at the discretion of the Examiners.
  - (iv) that the candidate be deemed not to have attained the standard required for the degree of MD and that no further opportunity be allowed for examination.



### 31. Ordinance and Regulations for Higher Doctorates

#### Ordinance

1. The Degree of Doctor may be conferred as follows, after report from the Board of the appropriate Faculty, upon graduates of this University of not less than seven years' standing who are adjudged to have distinguished themselves by their published contribution to learning:

|                                                        |                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Faculties of Arts and Social and Environmental Studies | Degree of Doctor of Letters (LittD)           |
| Faculties of Science and Medicine                      | Degree of Doctor of Science (DSc)             |
| Faculty of Engineering                                 | Degree of Doctor of Engineering (DEng)        |
| Faculty of Social and Environmental Studies            | Degree of Doctor of Laws (LLD)                |
| Faculty of Veterinary Science                          | Degree of Doctor of Veterinary Science (DVSc) |

2. Higher Doctorates may be awarded by the University in recognition of published work and/or other material of distinction resulting from research which, in the opinion of the external assessors appointed to examine the work:
  - (a) possesses originality and merit;
  - (b) makes a sustained, consistent and substantial contribution to the advancement of knowledge over a number of years;
  - (c) establishes the candidate's authoritative standing in his/her field of work;
  - (d) has led to extensions or development of knowledge by others.

#### Regulations

1. Candidates should, in the first instance, submit their full *curriculum vitae* and list of publications to the Dean of the appropriate Faculty, together with a statement of the award intended, a précis of the work to be submitted (not less than 500 words and not more than 2,500 words stating the main contributions to learning of the work submitted in the application) and a proposed title.
2. The Dean of the appropriate Faculty will arrange for initial consideration in the Faculty to ensure that the candidate is eligible to apply, can make a *prima facie* case for assessment and can present appropriate published material in a suitable manner, before preparing their full application.
3. If, following initial consideration, the Dean of the appropriate Faculty considers that a *prima facie* case for examination exists, the candidate shall be informed in writing and invited to submit three copies of their application within six months of the decision.
4. Each copy of the submission must be permanently bound in book form with stiff covers; the title of the work shall be shown on the front cover, and the candidate's surname, initials, degree and the year on the spine.
5. Each copy of the application must contain the following:
  - (a) A *curriculum vitae* of the candidate.
  - (b) A précis of the work to be submitted (not less than 500 words and not more than 2,500 words) stating the main contributions to learning of the work submitted in the application.
  - (c) A list of the candidate's publications grouped according to subject and numbered accordingly.
  - (d) A copy of each publication submitted in support of the application which should be numbered to correspond with the numbers on the list referred to in (c).

Copies of publications containing material for which a degree has already been awarded may be included for completeness, but this fact must be clearly indicated on the list mentioned in (b). Where joint authorship occurs, a statement of the contribution made by the applicant should be given together with the status of the other authors.

6. The application must be addressed to the Chief Operating Officer and be accompanied by the appropriate fee.
7. The application shall be submitted to at least two external assessors nominated by the Board of the Faculty concerned, who shall present independent reports to the Dean of the Faculty on the work submitted and independent reasoned recommendations as to whether or not the degree should be awarded.
8. The assessment of the application shall be completed within six months of presentation of the full submission.
9. The Dean of the appropriate Faculty shall consider the reports jointly and may thereafter, if the assessors' recommendations differ, consult an additional external assessor who shall be appointed in a similar manner to that followed in appointing the original external assessors.
10. The Dean of the appropriate Faculty shall inform the candidate of the success or otherwise of the submission.
11. A copy of the thesis or other documentation approved for the degree will be retained in the University Library.
12. Candidates may be permitted, at the discretion of the Senate, to re-apply at a later date where the assessors recommend that the degree be not awarded.
32. Regulations for Research Degree Appeals

These regulations are applicable to students registered on programmes leading to one of the following awards:

Master of Research,  
 Master of Philosophy  
 Professional Doctorate  
 Doctor of Medicine  
 Doctor in Philosophy

Some of the above programmes contain taught modules or components which are marked using a mark scale with a defined pass mark. Regulation 1 below deals with the process and conditions whereby a student may request a Board of Examiners to check the mark awarded. The remaining regulations deal with possible appeals against the final decision of the Examiners.

1. In the case of individual taught modules or components, which are assessed using a mark scale with a defined pass mark, a candidate may request the Board of Examiners to check an assessment or examination mark or result or to consider the conduct of assessment on the following grounds:
  - (i) that there was an administrative error in recording or calculating the mark or result;
  - (ii) that there was a procedural error in the conduct of the assessment.

If an administrative or procedural error is found the mark or result will be amended or adjusted as deemed appropriate by the Board of Examiners. Any consequent decision of the Board of Examiners will be final. If no error is found, the candidate may only continue to progress an assessment appeal in accordance with the following regulations.
2. A candidate for a postgraduate research degree may appeal against any of the following decisions made by either the Board of Examiners or by the Examiners appointed to assess a written thesis:-
  - (i) that the candidate be deemed not to have attained the standard required for the degree and that no further opportunity be allowed for examination;

- (ii) that a different award from that which the candidate was attempting to qualify be made (e.g. MPhil instead of PhD);
  - (iii) that a candidate be required to resubmit their thesis either for the intended award or for a lesser award (e.g. MPhil instead of PhD).
  - (iv) that no mark of distinction be given. (applicable only for MRes awards).
3. A candidate may give notice of appeal against the decision of a Board of Examiners or the Examiners appointed to assess a written thesis on one or more of the following grounds:
- (i) that there were procedural irregularities in the conduct of the examination (including alleged administrative error) of such a nature as to cause reasonable doubt as to whether the Examiners would have reached the same conclusion if they had not occurred;
  - (ii) that there exist exceptional circumstances affecting the candidate's performance of which the Examiners were not aware when their decision was taken;
  - (iii) that there is evidence of prejudice or of bias or of inadequate assessment on the part of one or more of the Examiners.
  - (iv) that the supervision or other arrangements during the candidate's period of study were unsatisfactory.

Appeals made under clauses (ii) and (iv) may only be considered if there is "good reason" for the candidate not to have taken action via the Annual Progress Report process or made a complaint (using the University's Complaints Procedure) at an earlier stage or not to have informed the Examiners of any exceptional circumstances.

Appeals can not be made on any grounds which dispute the academic judgement of the Examiners.

- 4. A candidate shall submit any appeal in writing to the Dean of the Faculty concerned within ten days of receiving notification of the result of the examination.
- 5. The Dean of the Faculty concerned, in consultation with the Dean of Graduate Studies and the Director of Postgraduate Research, shall forward to the Vice-Chancellor any appeal duly received and shall advise the Vice-Chancellor whether the case is of sufficient substance to be given further consideration.
- 6. The Vice-Chancellor shall determine whether an appeal warrants consideration by the Research Degree Appeals Board.
- 7. If the Vice-Chancellor determines that an appeal does not warrant such consideration, the appeal shall be dismissed and the candidate shall be informed of the reasons for its dismissal.
- 8. The Research Degree Appeals Board shall consist of a Pro-Vice-Chancellor (who shall be Chairman) together with two other members of the Senate.
- 9. Appointments to the Research Degree Appeals Board shall be made in the following manner: the Senate shall appoint, for a period not exceeding three years in each instance, a panel consisting of six members of the Senate. The appointments shall be made in such manner as to secure a rotation of the membership of the panel, two members retiring each year. Two members shall be nominated from the panel by the Vice-Chancellor to serve on the Research Degree Appeals Board and, where appropriate, an External Advisor, shall be appointed to advise the Board in any given case.
- 10. The Registrar or his representative shall be the Secretary to the Research Degree Appeals Board.
- 11. It shall be the duty of the Research Degree Appeals Board to consider and decide upon appeals referred to it by the Vice-Chancellor.
- 12. When an appeal is referred to the Research Degree Appeals Board, the candidate who lodged the appeal shall receive a written notice from the Registrar:

- (i) giving at least ten days notice of the date on which the appeal will be considered by the Board;
  - (ii) informing them that they have the right to present their case in person and to be accompanied by a member of the University of their choice or to nominate a member of the University to appear for them.
13. When an appeal is made on the grounds stated in Clause 3(iii), the Examiners will be invited to respond to the appeal via the Secretary to the Board. When an appeal is made on the grounds stated in Clause 3(iv), the Supervisors will be invited to respond via the Secretary to the Board.
14. The Board, having considered the evidence and taken such advice as may be necessary, shall take one of the following decisions:
- (i) where the appeal is on either of the grounds stated in Clause 3(i) and 3(ii) of these Regulations:
    - (a) to reject the appeal, in which case the decision is final;
    - (b) to recommend to the Examiners that, for reasons stated, they should reconsider their decision;
    - (c) to give the candidate permission to revise the thesis and resubmit for re-examination;
  - (ii) where the appeal is on the grounds stated in Clause 3(iii) of these Regulations:
    - (a) to reject the appeal, in which case the decision is final;
    - (b) to determine that the thesis should be re-examined.
  - (iii) where the appeal is on the grounds stated in Clause 3(iv) of these regulations:
    - (a) to reject the appeal, in which case the decision is final;
    - (b) to allow the candidate an opportunity to submit a revised thesis for examination under conditions to be determined by the Research Degree Appeals Board.
15. If the Board determines that the thesis should be re-examined, in accordance with Clause 14(ii)(b) of these Regulations, the following procedures shall be followed:
- (i) new Examiners shall be appointed, on the nomination of the Board of the Faculty concerned, in number not fewer than the original Examiners and including not fewer than two External Examiners;
  - (ii) the Examiners shall be informed that they are conducting a re-examination on appeal and shall be given no other information about the original examination;
  - (iii) the Examiners shall submit independent reports on the thesis to the Director of Postgraduate Research before they examine the candidate orally;
  - (iv) the reports and recommendations of both the original and the new Examiners shall be considered by the Director of Postgraduate Research who will make a recommendation to the Senate, which shall then determine whether or not the degree should be awarded;
  - (v) if the recommendations of the new Examiners differ from those of the original Examiners, any agreed recommendation of the new Examiners shall normally be approved.

The Secretary to the Research Degree Appeals Board is Mrs H Knight, Director of the Student Administration and Support Division, from whom further advice can be obtained. Contact can be made by phone on 794 2038 or 42038 (internal) or by email to [Heather.Knight@liverpool.ac.uk](mailto:Heather.Knight@liverpool.ac.uk).

## APPENDIX I: THESIS PREPARATION

### 1. Presentation of Theses

The following notes have been produced for the guidance of research degree candidates in the presentation of their theses. All students, however, should ensure that they also consult their supervisor(s) about the presentation of their theses.

- (i) Sources  
Candidates must state generally in the preface and specifically in the body of the thesis the sources from which their information is derived and the extent to which they have availed themselves of the work of others.
- (ii) Length  
The various Regulations require that a thesis should be as concise as possible. In no circumstances should a thesis of more than 100,000 words be submitted for PhD or MD (60,000 for MPhil) including the footnotes and appendices, unless written permission has been obtained from the candidate's supervisor, the Head of the Department and the appropriate Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research. It is recommended that the Head of Department seek the view of potential examiners before granting his/her approval.
- (iii) References  
References to published work should be given consistently in a format that is currently accepted in the field of work covered by the thesis. If in doubt, candidates should consult their supervisors about the best method.
- (iv) Number of copies required  
Three copies of the thesis and any supporting papers are normally required. Two copies should be deposited in the Student Administration Centre, who will make arrangements for the examination of the thesis. The candidate should retain one copy. However, if three Examiners are appointed, three copies must be submitted.  
  
After the examination, the University will retain two copies in permanent bindings. One of these copies will be retained in the University Library. The candidate's supervisor will retain the other copy.  
  
PGR students registering from 1 August 2008 are required to submit an electronic copy of the final approved version of their thesis. Guidelines for the submission of electronic theses are available from the University Library.
- (v) Restrictions on access to theses  
An author may impose restrictions on access to theses and copying annually for up to five years, if the Head of Department endorses the author's statement that such restriction is necessary for good reasons, e.g. preparation for publication or a patent application. This will not prevent the publication of the Abstract. Permanent restriction is not permitted, nor does the University accept theses written under contracts of secrecy (see section 18 above and the Note on Theses in the current edition of the *University Calendar*).
- (vi) Presentation and Layout  
In the following specification some of the requirements of BS 4821:1990 have been adopted to ensure that doctoral theses conform to the standards expected by the British Library. Copies of the British Standard (now withdrawn from publication) may be consulted in the Sydney Jones and Harold Cohen Libraries. Authors' rights are protected under the University's agreement with the British Library.

(vii) Typing, printing and copying

Type must be uniform and clear in all copies, for both text and illustrations. The minimum height for capital letters is 2 mm and the minimum x-height (height of lower-case 'x') 1.5 mm. The main body of the text must be in black ink on white paper.

A personal computer with a printer of good quality (*e.g.* laser or inkjet) must be used to produce the first copy. Good, permanent photocopies on plain paper are acceptable for the second and third copies. Copies made by chemical means, which may fade, are not. The copier must be checked before use to ensure that it does not produce extraneous marks on the copies.

(viii) Binding and lettering

Theses may be presented for examination in either permanent or temporary bindings.

- *Permanent binding*

The thesis to be bound in book form in a strong cloth of any suitable colour. Maximum thickness 65 mm (2½"): if of greater thickness, two or more volumes per copy will be required. The binding of all volumes must be identical. The thesis should be bound in such a way that it can be opened fully for ease of microfilming.

*Lettering* on permanent bindings to be in gold. *Front cover*: title of thesis. *Spine*: Top: degree. Middle: surname and initials. Bottom: year of submission.

- *Temporary binding*

The thesis should be presented in such a way that the pages cannot be readily removed (therefore ring binders and spiral binding are not permitted). The candidate's surname, initials, the date (month and year) and the degree to be shown on the outside front cover.

After the thesis has been approved by the Examiners, two copies must be permanently bound as above and deposited with the Student Administration Centre before arrangements for the conferment of the degree can be made.

(ix) Title page

*(Centred)* Title of thesis

*then* 'Thesis submitted in accordance with the requirements of the University of Liverpool for the degree of Doctor in Philosophy (or other degree as appropriate) by *full forenames and surname*.'  
*then (centred)* Date (month and year) with suitable line spacing.

(x) Table of contents

The table of contents must show chapter headings and page numbers. All separate sections of the thesis, such as bibliography, lists of abbreviations, supporting papers, etc., must also be identified on the contents page.

(xi) Abstract

Each copy of the thesis must be accompanied by a separate copy of the Abstract indicating the aims of the investigation and the results achieved. For microfilming purposes it must:

- be typed or printed; good photocopies are acceptable;
- be not longer than can be accomplished by single-spaced type on one side of an A4 sheet (about 450 words);
- show the author and title of the thesis in the form of a heading.

(xii) Paper

A4 white bond paper of 70 to 100 g/m<sup>2</sup> weight must be used for both originals and photocopies, except for any endpapers which carry no text. If both sides of the paper are used, then:

- both sides must be used in both copies which are to be permanently bound;
- there must be little or no 'show-through': paper lighter than 80 g/m<sup>2</sup> should not be used;
- the full binding margin of 40 mm must be allowed on the *left* side of odd pages and the *right* side of even pages. Other margins must be 25mm minimum.

- (xiii) Margins and line spacing  
1½ line spacing is advised, but at least double line spacing should be used for text that contains many subscripts and superscripts. Quotations may be indented. Authors should check the text carefully for ‘widows and orphans’ and make full use of all error-checking facilities.
- (xiv) Page numbers  
Pages should be numbered consecutively and the position of page numbers (candidate’s choice or as advised by the supervisor) should be consistent throughout.
- (xv) Footnotes  
Footnotes should be inserted at the foot of the relevant page in single line spacing. Smaller type may be used, if available. A line should be ruled between footnotes and the text. Footnotes should be numbered consecutively throughout the thesis.
- (xvi) Diagrams, maps, illustrations and supporting material  
Diagrams, maps and illustrations should be placed as near to the relevant text as possible. If it is necessary to place illustrations in a separate volume, the binding must match that of the text. Photographs must be prints of good quality and adequate size. Identical and permanent prints of any monochrome or colour photographs used must be securely mounted in each copy of the thesis.

Published papers submitted in support of the thesis should be sewn in by the bookbinder as an appendix.

Essential material that cannot be sewn in (large charts, tapes, floppy disks, CDs, microfiches, etc.) must be placed securely in a pocket attached to the inside back cover of each copy by the bookbinder. Before submitting material that cannot be read without special facilities, candidates must satisfy themselves and their supervisors (*a*) that it is essential to include such material and (*b*) that the Examiners have ready access to such facilities.

## 2. Further Advice

The Graduate School’s module in Vital, “Postgraduate Research Students”, contains a range of materials and related bibliographies that offer advice on the preparation of theses, methods of bibliographical reference and preparation for the viva. Further information about this resource can be found on the Graduate School web-site at [http://www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool/tools\\_resources/vitalresources.htm](http://www.liv.ac.uk/gradschool/tools_resources/vitalresources.htm).

## APPENDIX II: Academic Appeals

### Notes for the Guidance of Students Intending to Submit an Academic Appeal

NB: The Regulations governing the appeals procedure are available in Section IV of this handbook.

- (i) If you intend to submit an appeal against a decision not to award a degree, or not to allow resubmission for a degree, you must consult a copy of the Regulations governing the academic appeals procedure at postgraduate research degree level.
- (ii) When submitting an appeal in writing to the Dean of the Faculty, you must specify precisely the grounds on which the appeal is based. The grounds are defined in Clause 1 of the Regulations.
- (iii) If your appeal is based on more than one of the grounds as defined in the Regulations, you should structure your arguments carefully, dealing with each ground in turn. You should bear in mind that, if the Vice-Chancellor decides that your case is to be considered by the Research Degree Appeals Board, your appeal statement submitted to the Dean would be considered subsequently by the Board. You should therefore take care to ensure that, for each of the grounds stated, you supply comprehensive and accurate evidence. Your comments should be confined to facts rather than opinions.
- (iv) The following guidelines should be noted when constructing an appeal:

#### *Regulation 1(i)*

If you consider that there were procedural irregularities in the conduct of the examination, you should give a detailed explanation showing the precise sequence of events. You must also state your reasons as to why you consider that the Examiners would have reached a different conclusion if such irregularities had not taken place.

#### *Regulation 1(ii)*

If there exists exceptional circumstances affecting your performance, of which the Examiners were not aware when their decision was taken, you should give full details of these circumstances. You should explain the reasons why the Examiners were not made aware of these circumstances and, if ill health is involved, you must include the appropriate supporting medical evidence.

#### *Regulation 1(iii)*

If you consider that there is evidence of prejudice or of bias or of inadequate assessment on the part of one or more of the Examiners, you must state clearly what your evidence is.

In instances where you consider that prejudice or bias was apparent, you must give informative illustrations and examples. If you consider that your assessment was inadequate you must support your view with factual evidence only.

- (v) If the Vice-Chancellor determines that your appeal warrants consideration by the Research Degree Appeals Board, you will be provided with information concerning the Examiners' report. It is important to bear in mind that Examiners' reports are private and confidential and the form in which the report is made available both to yourself and the Research Degree Appeals Board is wholly dependent on the University obtaining the appropriate permission from the Internal and External Examiners involved. If the Examiners are unable to give such permission, they will be informed that the appellant and the Research Degree Appeals Board will be given an unattributable summary of the main points of their reports.
- (vi) Before the hearing takes place, you will also be provided with a summary of the evidence available to the Board.
- (vii) When an appeal is on the grounds that there is evidence of prejudice or of bias or of inadequate assessment on the part of one or more of the Examiners, the Board may invite one or more expert witnesses to be present at the hearing. Both the Board and yourself may put questions to the expert witnesses but such persons will remain in the room only during your presence. You should note carefully that, if your appeal



is based not only on those grounds shown in Regulation 1(iii), any questions which you put to an expert witness must be confined solely to matters concerned *directly* with allegations of prejudice or of bias or of inadequate assessment on the part of one or more of the Examiners.

- (viii) When you receive a written notice of the date on which the appeal will be considered by the Board, you will also be informed of the membership of the Board and if appropriate, the name(s) of any expert witness(es) attending the hearing. You will be requested to provide the name of a member of the University if you elect to be accompanied at the hearing or have that member appear on your behalf.
- (ix) Under normal circumstances the Board will inform you of its decision immediately following its deliberations. The Registrar or his/her nominee will also notify you in writing of the decision of the Board. If your appeal is unsuccessful, the Board will inform you of the grounds on which it has reached its decision.

## APPENDIX III: Complaints Procedure

### Complaints Procedure

The University has established a complaints procedure for all students, including postgraduate research students. Details of the procedure may be found on the following web pages:

[http://www.liv.ac.uk/tqsd/pol\\_strat\\_cop/stud\\_complnt\\_proc.doc](http://www.liv.ac.uk/tqsd/pol_strat_cop/stud_complnt_proc.doc)

## APPENDIX IV: Policy on Students undertaking Teaching Duties

### University Policy on Postgraduate Students and Postgraduate/Postdoctoral Research Staff undertaking Teaching Duties

1. Postgraduate students who are registered for a higher degree and postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff should be allowed and encouraged to undertake a limited amount of teaching and continuous assessment work when appropriate.
2. The participation of such individuals in teaching should be subject to the approval of their Supervisor or Supervisory Committee (if they are registered for a higher degree) and the Head of Department and, in the case of postgraduate students, should be on a voluntary basis. Postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff should not be required to carry out teaching activities unless at the time of their appointment or subsequently it has been agreed with them that such activities should form part of their duties. Care should be taken to comply with the terms of any external sponsorship or research grant funding for the individual relating to teaching activity.
3. Any teaching activity undertaken by postgraduate students or postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff should be subject to a letter of agreement, setting out the duties and the amount of time (contact and preparation) to be spent on the activity and, if appropriate, the payment which will be made. Each agreement will require the signature of the student or researcher, the Supervisor (when the student or member of the research staff is registered for a higher degree), the Head of his/her Department, the member of staff responsible for the module and Head of the Department in which the teaching is to take place. The latter will be responsible for originating the letter of agreement. Recommended forms for these letters of agreement are appended to this policy document. In the case of any dispute over the implementation of the agreement the matter should first be considered by the Head of Department in which the teaching takes place. If it cannot be resolved in this way, it should be referred to the Director of Human Resources for conciliation.
4. The maximum amount of time any full-time postgraduate student or postgraduate/postdoctoral researcher may spend on teaching or assessment activity, including preparation time, whenever it is undertaken, is fifteen hours per week. Where postgraduate students have an upper limit on the number of hours worked imposed by their sponsor, this should be adhered to. Where such activity is spread unevenly during the year, an average of fifteen hours per week through a semester may be used as the basis for the agreement. In exceptional cases, particularly for teaching that involves field courses where the number of hours is difficult to quantify and the distribution is very uneven, variation to this condition may be arranged, subject to agreement by the Dean of Faculty.
5. No Supervisor may request that a postgraduate student or postgraduate/postdoctoral researcher undertake any teaching or assessment activity, informally, outside of the agreed arrangement.
6. Teaching and assessment activity may include laboratory demonstration/practical work, field courses, tutorials, language teaching and marking of practicals, assignments or essays. In accordance with the University's Code of Practice on Assessment, all work marked by postgraduate students or postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff must be appropriately moderated and postgraduate students and postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff must not act as the sole examiner of any summatively assessed work. Postgraduate students and postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff may undertake occasional formal lectures on areas within their expertise provided appropriate training has been given.
7. All postgraduate students undertaking any teaching activity should be paid the appropriate fee, set from time to time by the University.
8. It is the joint responsibility of the postgraduate student or postgraduate/postdoctoral researcher and the supervisor/grantholder to ensure that any external funding agency supporting the student/researcher allows teaching/assessment work to be undertaken. If the conditions imposed by a sponsor in relation to teaching activities are different from those set out in this policy document (e.g. those of four-year clinical training/PhD programmes funded by the Wellcome Trust or others), then the sponsor's conditions or

accepted practices should prevail, provided that the maximum of fifteen hours per week teaching limit is not exceeded.

9. No postgraduate student or postgraduate/postdoctoral researcher shall undertake any teaching without appropriate training and initial supervision. In particular, each Department should arrange for attendance at a training session at the start of each academic year by any postgraduate students or postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff whom they wish to use as teaching assistants for the first time. Such training may be provided by individual departments, by groups of cognate departments or by the Centre for Lifelong Learning. The training should equip the students/researchers with the skills required to carry out effectively the teaching duties which they will be undertaking and should include advice on assessment and providing tutorial support, as appropriate. Relevant health and safety issues should also be covered.
10. Each department should identify a member of its academic staff to act as Postgraduate/Postdoctoral Teaching Mentor. They will take responsibility for all quality assurance issues concerned with the teaching activities of postgraduate students and postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff and deal with any problems arising from this work that any individual might have. Mentors should be trained and the Centre for Lifelong Learning will provide such training.
11. In addition to such generic training, postgraduate students and postgraduate/postdoctoral research staff should receive advice from a designated staff member for each module or activity they support; this designated staff member will normally be the lecturer involved. They should meet to clarify the aims, objectives and content of the programme and the module involved, the method of assessment to be used, the nature of the teaching required and the support which will be offered by the staff member. The Postgraduate/Postdoctoral Teaching Mentor is responsible for ensuring that such meetings take place and that the level of support required is provided, and in each case they will require a statement to this effect signed by both parties.
12. Work undertaken should be added to any record of achievement established for postgraduate students. As a minimum, the student should receive from the Head of Department in which the teaching is carried out a formal statement of the work performed.
13. Advertising of teaching opportunities should be fair and open in accordance with the University's equal opportunity policy.
14. Annex C to this policy document describes the policy in relation to the use of junior clinical staff in training positions in the Faculty of Veterinary Science and Annex D describes the policy in relation to the involvement in teaching and assessment in the Faculty of Medicine of lecturers (clinical) and NHS staff holding honorary or part-time contracts who are undertaking NHS training programmes.

The full document with the above annexes may be found at:

[http://www.liv.ac.uk/sas/administration/pg\\_teaching\\_policy2003.pdf](http://www.liv.ac.uk/sas/administration/pg_teaching_policy2003.pdf)

Approved by the Senate 8 March 2000

Amendments approved on behalf of the Academic Committee by the Chairman of the Committee on 20 July 2000

Further amendment approved by the Senate 29 November 2000

Further amendments approved by the Senate 5 March 2003

## APPENDIX V: Policy in Respect of Long-term Suspensions of Studies on medical grounds for PGR Students

1. As a first request on medical grounds, a student may, at the discretion of the Director of the Graduate School, be granted a suspension of no more than one full year. Periods must be requested in whole months, from one month to a maximum of twelve, and supported by medical evidence from a GP or consultant. Requests for suspensions of longer than twelve months will be rejected automatically.
2. The student must contact their department after eleven months of the twelve-month suspension have elapsed, to confirm their intentions. If a shorter period of suspension is granted, the expectation would be that the student would contact the department at least two weeks before the suspension ends. If after a sum total of 12 months suspension the student is not in a position to resume studies, the University may require them to see a medical practitioner of its choice, or may accept the opinion of a practitioner chosen by the student. In either case, the medical report must offer an opinion as to whether the student is likely to be able to resume studies in no more than six further months.
3. Where the medical evidence clearly states an expectation of studies being resumed after no more than six further months, a further suspension will normally be permitted for that period only. After this, the student will be expected to resume studies and, if this is not possible, the registration will lapse.
4. Where the medical evidence states that the student will be unlikely to resume within six further months, or where no supporting medical evidence is obtained, no further suspension of studies will be permitted. If the student is not prepared to resume studies at that point, the registration will lapse.
5. Where registration is lapsed, the student should be written to. The letter should set out why a further suspension cannot be considered, and should make clear that, in instances where a student's health improves in the future, a new application for postgraduate study would be considered.

## APPENDIX VI: Termination of Studies

### Procedure for Terminating Postgraduate Research Students' Studies on the Grounds of Unsatisfactory Progress

#### Stage One

1. If a student's progress is thought to be unsatisfactory at any point during the academic year, the student should be warned of the situation in writing. This may take one of the following forms:
  - i. a formal letter from the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research, or
  - ii. a formal recommendation on the student's Annual Progress Report. The student must be made aware of such a recommendation if this route is used.
2. Whichever format is used, written warnings should detail the reasons for concern, and set clear targets for improving performance. A realistic timescale for achieving the improved progress must be set, which should not be less than two months for a full-time student. It should also be stated how the student's efforts in satisfying the targets will be evaluated and by whom. Evaluation should involve all supervisors and at least one independent member of staff, normally the Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research.
3. If a letter is sent to the student, it must be copied to Student Administration and Support to be entered onto the student's file.
4. Where a student responds to the written warning and satisfies the supervisors and Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research that progress is now satisfactory, this should also be confirmed in writing by the DDPR, with a copy to the supervisors and Student Administration and Support. This will end the process. Any concerns about progress in the future would require the procedure to be commenced again at Stage One.

#### Stage Two

5. If a student does not respond to the written warning, or does not satisfactorily meet the targets set or otherwise gives continued cause for concern, a Graduate School Progress Panel meeting must be convened which will be chaired by the University Director of Postgraduate Research and will comprise the student, supervisors, Departmental Director of Postgraduate Research and the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research. At least one member of the Progress Panel must be independent of the supervisory team.
6. The meeting will be used to discuss concerns in detail. At the end of the meeting, the Progress Panel will decide either:
  - i. to terminate the student's studies immediately, or
  - ii. to give the student a final opportunity to improve his/her performance, setting agreed tasks by a specified date.
7. A letter must be sent by the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research giving details of the agreed outcome of the Progress Panel meeting. If option (ii) is used, students will be informed that failure to meet any of the requirements of the Progress Panel will result in termination of studies. The letter must be copied to Student Administration and Support to be entered onto the student's file.

#### Stage Three

8. If the Progress Panel agree to give the student a final opportunity to improve progress and a letter to that effect was sent, the panel must agree who amongst them has responsibility for considering the student's response. In most cases, this will be the supervisors. The panel must also agree the timescale within

which the student must respond.

9. If a student has addressed the concerns over progress and met the conditions specified in the letter sent by the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research, the supervisors should inform the Faculty Director of this in writing, with a copy to Student Administration and Support. This will end the process. Any concerns over future progress would require this procedure to be commenced from Stage One.
10. If the student has not met the conditions imposed, the supervisors must report this failure to the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research, who will write to the student informing them that their registration is terminated. The letter must be copied to Student Administration and Support to be entered onto the student's file.

### Right of Appeal

11. If the recommendation at either Stage Two or Stage Three of this procedure is to terminate a student's registration, the student may appeal to the University Director of Postgraduate Research. However, an appeal may ONLY be made on one of the following grounds:
  - i. that there is evidence that the student's case did not receive fair consideration by the Department and the Faculty as a consequence of some procedural irregularity, or
  - ii. that some new evidence is available which could not, for good reason, have been made available at the time of the Faculty's decision to terminate studies.
12. In order for an appeal to be considered, it must be received by Student Administration and Support, The University of Liverpool, Foundation Building, 765 Brownlow Hill, Liverpool, L69 7ZX, within ten days of the receipt of the written decision of the Graduate School.
13. It is essential that all relevant information is given in the appeal letter and that it is accompanied by all supporting documents which The University Director of Postgraduate Research will need to consider. The University Director of Postgraduate Research will be advised by the Graduate School Administrator on whether there is a *prima facie* case for an appeal to be heard. He has the right to allow an appeal if he agrees that there are appropriate grounds, or to turn down the appeal.
14. If The University Director of Postgraduate Research agrees to allow the appeal, a Progress Appeal Panel will be convened, which will be chaired by the University Director of Postgraduate Research and include two Faculty Directors of Postgraduate Research from outside the student's faculty. A member of the senior administrative staff will act as Secretary. The Chairman and Secretary will be free to seek additional information from all relevant parties in advance of the Appeal Panel meeting, but any papers submitted in addition to those from the student must be made available to the student at least one week in advance of the meeting.
15. At the meeting, the student may be accompanied by a 'friend' such as a fellow student or member of University staff. The student will be invited to restate their case, if they wish. The Panel will have the opportunity to ask any questions or clarify points of fact, as well as to explain the University's regulations or procedures as necessary. The student and/or their friend will have a final opportunity to speak, following which the Panel may wish to consider the matter in private session. If it decides to do so, the student will withdraw until a decision is reached, then will be invited back to hear the decision.
16. The Progress Appeals Panel may decide:
  - i. that the appeal is upheld, in which case the matter is formally referred back to the Faculty Director of Postgraduate Research in the student's faculty. The reasons which led to this decision will be clearly explained to the faculty. The faculty will be instructed to review its decision. The normal recommendation will be that such a review would effectively bring Stage Two (option ii) of the procedure into operation, with the student given a final opportunity to improve progress. However, the Panel may also recommend that the student be re-registered and the Termination

process be ended.

ii. that the appeal is denied. In this case, no further right of appeal exists.

17. In addition to the above formal process, the University reserves the right to terminate the registration of any student who fails to complete an Annual Progress Report form by 30 September in any year.



## APPENDIX VII: Copyright

### Copyright

Copyright is a complex subject that affects every member of the University. It is therefore important that all members of the University are informed about the law and the copying limits provided under the University's various licenses. An infringement of copyright law can be a criminal as well as a civil offence and every member of the University should be aware of the permitted copying limits and be responsible for ensuring that infringements do not take place.

Copyright Law protects works from being copied, modified or disseminated without the written permission of the copyright owner (rightsholder); this applies to all information recorded in a permanent or semi-permanent way including paper forms, audio-visual forms and electronic forms such as computer software and internet based information. Copyright does not have to be registered to exist; it is inherent in any created work and belongs to the creator(s), or his/her employer, unless it has been assigned to someone else in writing.

'Fair dealing' is referred to in the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 and currently applies to both paper and electronic copying (such as scanning, digitisation etc.) although new legislation is being prepared by the EU which may change the basic precepts of 'fair dealing'. Currently, the 'fair dealing' provision means that it is not an infringement of copyright to make a single copy of part of copyright material for the purposes of private research or study, reporting an event, or for the purpose of criticism or review. Multiple copying is not considered 'fair dealing'.

Although the University holds licenses that cover some areas of copyright works they are by no means comprehensive and many areas of electronic copying (scanning, digitisation etc.) are unlicensed and ambiguous regarding 'fair dealing'. Therefore, unless you are certain that you have permission to copy, modify or disseminate a complete work or part of a work, be it by photocopying or electronic means, you must check the licenses held by the University or gain permission from the rightsholder.

### Where to seek help and advice

Student Services can provide information on the limits of copyright licences held by the University, issues in electronic copyright and copies of the following:

- Higher Education Copying Accord
- List of Copyright Licensing Agency (CLA) Excluded Works
- List of Newspaper Licensing Agency (NLA) Mandated Newspapers
- Guide to Educational Recording Agency (ERA) Off-Air Recording.

The University Library provides information and advice about copyright and the short loan collection.

The Computing Services Department Helpdesk can provide information relating to the software licences held by the University and guidance on any issues concerning software and some facets of electronic copyright. Contact the Helpdesk on ext. 44567 or email [helpdesk@liverpool.ac.uk](mailto:helpdesk@liverpool.ac.uk)

Research and Business Services can be consulted regarding matters of intellectual property such as the assignment of copyright to publishers and the management of Patents.